BY ORDER OF THE
SECRETARY OF THE AIR FORCE

DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE
MANUAL 13-204 VOLUME 1

12 MARCH 2026

Nuclear, Space, Missile, or Command and Control Operations

MANAGEMENT OF AIRFIELD OPERATIONS

COMPLIANCE WITH THIS PUBLICATION IS MANDATORY

ACCESSIBILITY: Publications and forms are available on the e-Publishing website at **www.e-Publishing.af.mil** for downloading or ordering.

RELEASABILITY: There are no releasability restrictions on this publication.

OPR: AFFSA/XA

Certified by: AF/DA3O
(Col Yeatman)

Supersedes: AFMAN13-204V1, 22 July 2020

Pages: 88

This Department of the Air Force Manual (DAFMAN) implements Air Force Policy Directive (AFPD), 13-2, *Air Traffic Control*, *Airfield, Airspace, and Range Management*. This manual outlines key duties and responsibilities of airfield operations officers. This manual also provides detailed guidance, procedures and programs for managing airfield operations where the Air Force has functional oversight responsibility. It applies to the entire Department of the Air Force (DAF), including the United States Air Force (USAF), the United States Space Force, the Air Force Reserve (AFR), the Air National Guard (ANG), and those with a contractual obligation to abide by the terms of DAF issuances, except where noted otherwise, who operate or administer functions and facilities for airfield operations. At joint, shared-use, and overseas airfields, this manual applies to the facilities controlled and used exclusively by the Department of the Air Force, as outlined in international agreements, real estate documents or other written agreements. This manual may be supplemented at any level; however, all Major Command (MAJCOM) supplements to include interim changes to previously approved supplements must be routed to Air Force Flight Standards Agency, Director of Airfield Operations (AFFSA/XA) for coordination prior to certification and approval. References to MAJCOM within this publication refer to the MAJCOM Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR) for airfield operations. Unit (wing or base) level supplements to this publication must be routed to the responsible MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations for coordination prior to certification and approval. The authorities to waive wing, unit, or delta level requirements in this publication are identified with a Tier ("T-0, T-1, T-2, T-3") number following the compliance statement. See DAFMAN 90-161, *Publishing Processes and Procedures*, for a description of the authorities associated with the Tier numbers. Submit requests

for waivers through the chain of command to the appropriate Tier waiver approval authority, or alternately, to the squadron commander for non-tiered compliance items or requirements. Refer to **Chapter 1** for additional waiver requirements to this manual. Refer recommended changes and questions about this publication to the OPR using the DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*; route DAF Forms 847 from the field through the appropriate functional chain of command. Ensure all records generated as a result of processes prescribed in this publication adhere to Air Force Instruction 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, and are disposed in accordance with the Air Force Records Disposition Schedule, which is located in the Air Force Records Information Management System (AFRIMS). The use of the name or mark of any specific manufacturer, commercial product, commodity, or service in this publication does not imply endorsement by the Department of the Air Force.

SUMMARY OF CHANGES

This publication has been substantially revised and must be completely reviewed. Major changes include changing the publication from an Air Force Manual (AFMAN) to DAFMAN, added Airfield Operations Compliance Verification inspection procedures, adjusted Air Traffic Control (ATC)/Airspace facility closure requirements, and updated tier waiver authorities.

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Chapter 1

GENERAL

1.1. Overview. This manual provides guidance for managing airfield operations personnel (to include Department of Defense (DoD) civilians, contractors), facilities and airfields. Within the context of this manual, airfield operations is comprised of ATC; airfield management (AM); and radar, airfield and weather system (RAWS) services where the DAF has functional oversight responsibility. **Exception:** Airfield operations officers who do not have oversight responsibility over RAWS, when RAWS is another flight working directly for the operations support squadron commander (OSS/CC). This manual is complemented by DAFMAN 13-204, Volume 2, *Airfield Management*, DAFMAN 13-204 Volume 3, *Air Traffic Control* and DAFMAN 13-204 Volume 4, *Radar, Airfield and Weather Systems*.

1.1.1. For the purpose of this manual, airfield operations personnel are typically assigned to an operations support squadron which reports to an operations group commander (OG/CC). The OG/CC, which is also typically the senior operations commander, then reports to the wing commander.

1.1.2. When unit organizational alignment differs from the standard (squadron/group/wing) construct, the unit must identify positional authorities and/or responsibilities that differ.

1.2. The Military and Civilian Aviation Integration Division. The Military and Civilian Aviation Integration Division, Career Field Management is responsible for Air Force Specialty Codes (AFSCs) 13MX, Airfield Operations officer; 1C1X1, Air Traffic Control; and 1C7X1, Airfield Management, 1C8X3, Radar, Airfield and Weather Systems. Career Field Manager (CFM) duties will be executed in accordance with DAFMAN 36-2100, *Military Utilization and Classification*, Department of the Air Force Instruction (DAFI) 36-2670, *Total Force Development*, and AFI 38-101, *Manpower and Organization*. Administers the Air Force Airfield Operations Annual Awards in accordance with DAFMAN 36-2806, *Military Awards: Criteria and Procedures.* This list is not exclusive.

1.3. Air Force Flight Standards Agency (AFFSA). Air Force Flight Standards Agency is responsible for terminal area airfield operations (i.e., ATC, AM and RAWS) matters. In this capacity, AFFSA executes responsibilities as outlined in Air Force Mission Directive 27, *Air Force Flight Standards Agency (AFFSA)*, in keeping with policy guidance provided by the Air Staff. For the purpose of addressing specific procedural, training, standardization, architecture and integration issues directly related to airfield operations, AFFSA may have cause to interact with the MAJCOMs, Federal Aviation Administration (FAA), and other military services.

1.4. Operations at Contingency Locations. Contingency is defined as a situation requiring military operations in response to natural disasters, terrorists, subversives, or as otherwise directed by appropriate authority to protect United States' interests. At contingency locations, outside the United States, the senior airfield authority (SAA) may waive airfield operations procedures outlined in this manual to support tactical or combat operations. Where applicable, this authority is delegable to the senior operations commander. **(T-2)** Prior to issuance of such a waiver, the following actions must be accomplished:

1.4.1. Conduct a risk management assessment with the rationale for the waiver.

1.4.2. Forward proposed waivers to the DAF Forces staff or equivalent for an operational review if time permits, or at the discretion of the SAA. **(T-2)** See **paragraph 1.7** for additional requirements and waiver details.

1.4.3. Refer to Air Force Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures (AFTTP) 3-4.13V2, *Contingency Airfield Operations* for additional information. This AFTTP volume outlines how Air Force forces open and operate a deployed or contingency airfield. This AFTTP volume also contains planning considerations for AM, ATC, and deployable air traffic control and landing systems (ATCALS) capabilities, procedures, forces, and equipment.

1.5. Airfields Operated Pursuant to Contract. This manual applies to locations where DoD or DAF access is pursuant to contract, to the extent specifically outlined in the contract statement of work (SOW) and/or performance work statement (PWS). Locations unable to comply with this criteria due to pre-existing SOWs are exempt until such time that the current contract expires. Locations that intend to exclude the requirements of this manual, must specifically state the exclusions in the SOW. **(T-2)**

1.6. Overseas Locations. Any host nation procedures, or procedures based on otherwise inapplicable international regulations that are being implemented to fulfill basing or similar agreements should be implemented consistent with this manual to the extent possible. While agreed practices adopted for the DAF use in overseas areas take precedence, every effort should be made to conform to this manual.

1.6.1. MAJCOMs must identify any special procedures agreed with host nations in their supplement to this manual. Refer conflicting procedures to AFFSA prior to implementation.

1.6.2. Airfield operations personnel augmenting a facility operated by another branch of the U.S. military will comply with their regulations and procedures as applicable. **(T-0)**

1.7. Waivers.

1.7.1. Requestors will use the DAF Form 679, *Department of the Air Force Publication Compliance Item Waiver Request/Approval* to process waivers to this manual. **(T-1)** Additional waiver request details are contained in DAFMAN 90-161 Chapter 9.

1.7.2. Waiver requests must include the following:

1.7.2.1. A paragraph reference or text of the specific requirement for which the commander/director is requesting a waiver. **(T-1)**

1.7.2.2. Rationale for the waiver. **(T-1)** Explain which one of the following reasons apply and why: (1) how complying with the requirement/compliance item impacts mission accomplishment, (2) cost of compliance (training, funds, equipment, facilities, guidance or manpower) creates unacceptable risk to a higher priority task; or (3) expected cost of compliance outweighs the benefit; or (4) personnel cannot comply with the requirement due to a lack of resources (training, funds, equipment, facilities, guidance or manpower).

1.7.2.3. Time period or circumstance for which the waiver is needed. **(T-1) Note:** Tier 1, 2, and 3 waivers may be approved for a period not to exceed the requested waiver period or 90 calendar days after the approving commander's tour length, whichever is shorter. Because waivers are the expression of a specific commander's risk acceptance, approved waivers automatically expire 90 calendar days after a change in commander unless the new commander renews the waiver.

1.7.2.4. Risk mitigation measures to be implemented, if necessary, by the requesting commander during the waiver period. **(T-1)**

1.7.2.5. Impact if waiver is disapproved. **(T-1)**

1.7.3. If deemed necessary, submit additional data (e.g., letters of procedure, airspace maps, traffic patterns, airfield diagrams) to substantiate the waiver request.

1.7.4. Requestor must provide an informational copy of all Tier 3 approved waivers to MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations. **(T-2)**

1.7.5. Requestor will submit waivers to applicable FAA publications through their respective commander for coordination from the MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations, AFFSA/XA and the appropriate Air Force representative (AFREP). **(T-0)** The AFREP submits the request to FAA and notifies the requesting unit, MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations, and AFFSA/XA of the results.

1.7.6. The requesting commander must forward a copy of the approved waiver to the AFFSA/XA workflow at **hqaffsa.xa@us.af.mil** within 30 calendar days of approval for situational awareness and process improvement considerations. **(T-1)**

1.7.7. Approved waivers become part of the approver's and requestor's official records and are appropriately filed in accordance with AFI 33-322.

1.7.8. Exception to Guidance (ETG) Requests. ETG requests for individuals, or more commonly known as Exception to Policy, fall under criteria listed in DAFMAN 90-161 paragraph 9.1.1. ETG requests will be submitted to the applicable tiered waiver authority listed in DAFMAN 90-161 Table A101.1. **Note:** Units submitting an ETG request should ensure that their request does not also require CFM approval IAW conditions contained in DAFMAN 36-2689, *Training Program*.

1.7.8.1. The rationale section of an ETG request must address items in **paragraph 1.7.2** to ensure that the tiered waiver authority is fully informed of merits for, and risk assumption associated with approval. **(T-1) Note:** While there is not a standardized format for processing ETG requests, recommend requests utilize either memorandum format or DAF Form 679 for tracking purposes.

1.7.8.2. Units must provide AFFSA/XA a copy of all approved ETG requests. **(T-1)**.

1.8. Governing Directives. Airfield operations services are governed by DAFIs, DAFMANs, AFIs, AFMANs, and, to the extent applicable, FAA orders (FAAO), parts of the Code of Federal Regulations, and any host nation procedures which have been adopted for DAF use, unless specifically exempted or waived. Unit commanders may contact AFFSA through their respective MAJCOM OPR for assistance determining the applicability of directives. **Note:** Airfield operations personnel augmenting a facility operated by another branch of the U.S. military will comply with their regulations and procedures as applicable.

1.9. Issuing New Air Force Airfield Operations Guidance or Procedures. New guidance or procedures are sent out via message and posted on the AFFSA Airfield Operations SharePoint® website. Airfield operations staff personnel are required to utilize the AFFSA Airfield Operations SharePoint® website to download and/or view messages. **(T-1)**

1.10. Duty Titles. Duty titles are determined by the unit manpower document (UMD) authorizations earned through the 32F Capabilities-Based Manpower Determinant. **Note:** Failure to use authorizations as described and earned on the UMD could result in the reduction of authorizations or removal of personnel (not applicable to ANG and AFR). Request a variance to the manpower standard when additional related responsibilities and/or workload levied on the AOF merit increased manpower authorizations.

1.11. AOF Staff. The typical AOF staff is comprised of an Airfield Operations Flight Commander (AOF/CC); Airfield Operations Flight Director of Operations (AOF/DO); Airfield Operations Flight Systems Officer (AOF/SO); Airfield Manager (AFM); Maintenance Superintendent; Noncommissioned Officer-In-Charge (NCOIC) RAWS Quality Assurance Evaluator; Tower and/or Radar facility Chief Controller (CCTLR); NCOIC, ATC Training (NATCT); NCOIC, ATC Standardization and Evaluation (NSE); NCOIC, Airfield Automation Manager (NAAM); Airfield Operations System Specialist (AOSS); Terminal Instrument Procedures (TERPS) Specialist (if not consolidated at MAJCOM); and/or civilian equivalents.

Chapter 2

ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

2.1. AFFSA.

2.1.1. Establishes DAF guidance and procedures for providing airfield operations services through publication of this manual and corresponding volumes.

2.1.1.1. Serves as the OPR for DAF airfield operations guidance, procedures and programs.

2.1.2. Serves as Lead Agent for centrally managed ATCALS in accordance with (IAW) Department of the Air Force Policy Directive (DAFPD) 10-9, *Lead Command/Lead Agent Designation and Responsibilities for United States Air Force Weapon Systems, Non-Weapon Systems, and Activities*.

2.1.3. In coordination with airfield operations CFMs, develops and publishes standardized position certification and qualification guides; as well as education/training plans for both officer and enlisted Air Force Specialty Codes.

2.1.4. Conducts the Air Force TERPS Fundamentals course and procedures for Air Navigation Services – Aircraft Operations Differences Course in order to train and certify qualified individuals as TERPS specialists in accordance with DAFMAN 13-204V3 as well as applicable FAA, International Civil Aviation Organization (ICAO) and North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO) standards.

2.1.5. Evaluates Regular Air Force, Air National Guard, and Air Force Reserve unit requests for waivers and deviations to FAAO joint orders (FAAO JOs), cross-functional, airfield operations and instrument procedure policies and guidance.

2.1.6. Administers the Lieutenant General Gordon A. Blake Aircraft Save/Assist Award program in accordance with DAFMAN 36-2806.

2.1.7. Conducts regular, periodic system and DAF airfield operations data/trend analysis to monitor unit effectiveness, safety and compliance with established criteria or guidance.

2.1.8. Develops educational programs, publications, and bulletins to manage and actively promote airfield safety.

2.1.9. Develops Airfield Operations Compliance Verification (AO-CV) guidance, compliance checklists, and trend reporting.

2.1.9.1. Air Force Flight Standards Agency Airfield Operations Division (AFFSA/XA) provides USAF-level administrative management of the AO-CV and may, as prior coordinated, either observe or augment MAJCOM evaluation teams if staffing and resources permit.

2.1.9.2. Produces and distributes an annual calendar year trends and analysis report derived from consolidated AO-CV data to MAJCOM AO staffs. Applicable special interest items (SIIs) will be listed on this report.

2.1.10. Provides guidance to and oversight of MAJCOM and unit-level instrument procedure specialists IAW DAFMAN 11-230, *Instrument Procedures*. Conducts inspections of

MAJCOM and unit-level personnel performing TERPS functions. Refer to DAFMAN 11-230 for inspection details.

2.1.11. Develops headquarters Air Force-level self-assessment checklists (SAC) in accordance with DAFI 90-302, *The Inspection System of the Department of the Air Force* for units to assess effectiveness, safety, and compliance with applicable criteria.

2.1.12. Validates headquarters Air Force-level deficiencies with MAJCOM inspectors and functional area managers and evaluates unit corrective action plans for each valid actionable deficiency at the appropriate level.

2.1.13. Coordinates on document change proposals, and requests interpretation of FAA directives.

2.1.14. Manages policy, procedures and execution of the DAF Obstruction Evaluation/Airport Airspace Analysis Program.

2.1.15. Utilizes Air Force Safety Automated System to review airfield operations related hazardous air traffic reports (HATRs), controlled movement area violations (CMAVs), mishaps and bird/wildlife aircraft strike hazard (BASH) incidents for negative trends, root causes, observations and recommendations.

2.1.16. Reviews Class A and B mishap final messages/formal reports involving airfield operations and provide comments, if applicable, into the Air Force Safety Automated System reports. Refer to DAFI 91-204, *Safety Investigations and Reports*, and DAFMAN 91-223, *Aviation Safety Investigations and Reports* for additional information.

2.2. MAJCOM Airfield Operations.

2.2.1. Provides direct airfield operations functional oversight and assistance to facilitate activities/operations of subordinate unit airfield operations flights.

2.2.2. Works with the appropriate CFM, MAJCOM A1, and Air Force Personnel Center to ensure airfield operations flights are staffed in accordance with the 32F Capability Manpower Determinant to the maximum extent possible, while assigning units their allocation of manpower resources as available. **Note:** Not applicable to ANG and AFR units.

2.2.3. Publishes MAJCOM-unique guidance and airfield operating hours in a supplement.

2.2.4. Reviews and provides endorsing comments on DAF Form 679 and on waiver requests to airfield design criteria, markings, signs, and lighting forwarded for coordination by MAJCOM/A7 and/or Air Force Installation and Mission Support Center.

2.2.5. Establishes and conducts MAJCOM Airfield Operations annual awards selection process to compete at the DAF level in accordance with DAFMAN 36-2806.

2.2.6. Ensures appropriate airfield operations representation on aircraft mishap safety investigation boards (SIBs), as prescribed in DAFMAN 91-223. If the MAJCOM is unable to provide appropriate representation to the SIB, contact AFFSA/XA to locate a qualified SIB representative.

2.2.7. Implements the Air Force Runway Safety Action Team (AFRSAT) program, in accordance with this publication.

2.2.8. Supplements requirements for host nation/local national personnel filling airfield operations duty positions as required.

2.2.9. Notifies AFFSA of airfield operations related capability gaps.

2.2.9.1. Submit requests for new or additional centrally managed system(s) (system of record) to AFFSA Programs and Requirements Division (AFFSA/XR). Requestors will complete the notification of requirement(s) form on AFFSA/XR SharePoint® (**https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/affsa/90_Orgs/Forms/AllItems.aspx?csf=1&web=1&e=V8IQ5Q&cid=70c2e695%2D5380%2D4e36%2Db584%2Dde6c3bd7e051&RootFolder=%2Fsites%2Faffsa%2F90%5FOrgs%2FXR&FolderCTID=0x01200080610512BFEABB4D9505E038EE42D8F7**). Requests must include:

2.2.9.1.1. Unit requesting the change.

2.2.9.1.2. Location.

2.2.9.1.3. Organization.

2.2.9.1.4. Requirement Title (system needed).

2.2.9.1.5. Capability Gap that needs to be filled.

2.2.9.1.6. Date needed.

2.2.9.1.7. Funding availability.

2.2.9.1.8. Available logistics support.

2.2.9.1.9. Manpower available and required.

2.2.9.1.10. Pre-coordination with other agencies/host nation.

2.2.10. Opting out of a centrally managed system (system of record).

2.2.10.1. MAJCOMs desiring opt out of centrally managed system(s) (i.e., procure command-unique or decline to receive systems) will notify AFFSA/CC, as Lead Agent for ATCALS, in writing acknowledging overall responsibility for those systems. **Note:** This paragraph does not apply when fielded systems are being decommissioned by the unit or MAJCOM because of a change of mission.

2.2.11. Establishes a process for prioritizing and scheduling personnel identified by the units for career field supplemental courses, (e.g., Advanced Airfield Managers Course, Military Airspace Management Course, Chief Controller Course and Airfield Operations Systems Specialist Course). **Note:** Deployed airfield operations personnel will be scheduled for career field supplemental courses through their home-station MAJCOM.

2.2.12. Conduct AO-CV in accordance with **Attachment 7**.

2.2.12.1. Develop AO-CV evaluation team member training program and qualification requirements to ensure all team members are properly trained and qualified to perform evaluations at MAJCOM specified standards.

2.2.12.2. If needed, additional training items can be found in DAFI 90-302.

2.2.12.3. MAJCOM evaluation team members will prepare a report for each evaluation. See **paragraph A7.3.1** for guidance.

2.2.12.4. When a finalized inspection results in an overall INEFFECTIVE rating, the MAJCOM will notify AFFSA/XA org box (**hqaffsa.xa@us.af.mil**) within 1 duty day. **(T-1)**

2.2.13. Inspection funding is the responsibility of MAJCOMs.

2.2.14. Implement and manage AO-CV for units within their command, to include: scheduling evaluations IAW **Attachment 7** of this document, reporting results, and providing oversight to resolve identified deficiencies. **(T-2)** MAJCOM staff personnel should continually review applicable evaluation tools (SIIs and MICT checklists) listed on the AFFSA XA SharePoint® (**https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/affsa/SitePages/Airfield-Operations-Compliance-Verification.aspx**). To ensure currency and accuracy, MAJCOM AO staff will forward recommended changes to AFFSA/XA org box (**hqaffsa.xa@us.af.mil**).

2.2.14.1. MAJCOMs will ensure an upcoming (fiscal year) AO-CV schedule and augmentation requests to AFFSA and subordinate units is provided annually. **(T-1)**

2.2.14.2. Build inspection teams with full representation of the functional areas subject to evaluation and minimize footprint to the maximum extent possible. The team will consist of military and/or civilian equivalent qualified members from each functional area, including a 13M or civilian equivalent, as Team Chief. **(T-2)**

2.3. Airfield Operations Flight Commander (AOF/CC), or Civilian Equivalent. The AOF/CC is the wing's airfield operations focal point, responsible for managing services provided by AOF personnel. When more than one 13MX officer is assigned, the senior officer should be designated as the AOF/CC. Additional officers assigned to the AOF will be designated in accordance with **paragraph 2.3.3**.

2.3.1. ANG locations with AM and/or ATC can identify those managers as Air Traffic Managers or Airfield Operations Managers.

2.3.2. At locations where only Air Force AM exists, the Air Force does not provide ATC services, and a 13M is not authorized, the senior enlisted 1C7 or civilian equivalent will fulfill the responsibilities of the AOF/CC as outlined in this manual. **(T-3)**

2.3.3. 13MX Duty Positions. Refer to Career Field Education and Training Plan (CFETP) and other CFM guidance for duty position qualifications.

2.3.3.1. Unit level (in order of precedence). AOF Flight Commander (AOF/CC), AOF Director of Operations (DO), AOF Systems Officer (SO).

2.3.3.2. Staff level. Airfield operations officers are awarded AFSC 13M4 upon assignment to MAJCOM/Headquarters staff.

2.3.4. 13MX Developmental and Continuation Training. Several follow-on training courses are available to further the 13MX officer's professional development and fulfill training requirements for contingencies or other unique assignments. Every effort should be made to assist fully qualified officers in attending applicable courses relevant to 13MX development. Refer to CFETP and other CFM guidance for continuation and developmental training.

2.3.5. Training Record. Maintain a training record to keep training evaluations, position certifications and other applicable training products (i.e., CFETP, DAF Form 797, *Job Qualification Standard Continuation/Command JQS).*

2.4. AOF/CC Key Responsibilities.

2.4.1. Executing the Mission.

2.4.1.1. Ensures each facility has procedures to follow in the event of an aircraft mishap. See **Chapter 4** for additional information.

2.4.1.2. Participates in, and staffs, the Annual Airfield Certification/Safety Inspection for wing commander (WG/CC) or equivalent signature. See DAFMAN 13-204V2 for additional information.

2.4.1.3. Coordinates with military flight inspection agencies, ATC and RAWS maintenance, flying units, and other affected agencies and the FAA as appropriate, concerning flight inspection activities.

2.4.1.4. Provides oversight of civil and military airspace utilization, and development of procedures. Prepares airspace management agreements with sister services, allied forces, and civil authorities if appropriate, to facilitate the safe and effective integration of military and civil air traffic. Additional guidance on negotiating and concluding international agreements with allied forces is provided in DAFI 51-403, *International Agreements*

2.4.2. Leading People.

2.4.2.1. Selects outstanding airfield operations personnel and facility accomplishments for Air Force Annual Airfield Operations awards. See DAFMAN 36-2806 for additional information.

2.4.2.2. Uses the airfield operations staff qualifications and duty responsibilities specified in DAFMAN 13-204V1 thru 4 to designate personnel assigned to perform AOF staff functions. See Air Force Enlisted Classification Directory located on the myFSS website at: **https://myfss.us.af.mil** for additional information on enlisted qualifications and identifiers.

2.4.2.3. Conducts monthly training review board (TRB) to monitor and document the training status of AOF personnel. Publish board minutes and forward a copy to appropriate MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations no later than the 15th day of the month. **Note:** ANG, AFR, Morón Air Base, Creech, Clover, Tonopah and Pope Army Airfield conduct TRBs on a quarterly basis and are optional for AFCENT locations. See **Chapter 4** and **Attachment 5** for additional information.

2.4.3. Managing Resources.

2.4.3.1. Develops an airfield operations instruction (AOI) with a 13-series designation. **Note:** The AOI may be combined with the wing flying instruction which is usually assigned an 11-series designation. See **Attachment 2** for additional information.

2.4.3.2. Develops and manage local operating procedures (LOPs) to support airfield operations facilities and flying mission. Maintains a current index of applicable LOPs. The index and LOPs must be readily accessible to all AOF assigned personnel.

2.4.3.3. Ensures each facility has adequate staffing to support the mission.

2.4.3.4. Oversees program element code (PEC) funding account and assists MAJCOMs with program objective memorandum (POM) requests for funds when required.

2.4.3.5. At locations where RAWS falls within the Airfield Operations flight, the AOF/CC provides oversight of RAWS maintenance operations. Ensures RAWS maintains home-based and deployable ATCALS and equipment inventory list items.

2.4.4. Improving the Unit.

2.4.4.1. Conducts an Airfield Operations Board. See **paragraph 4.3** and **Attachment 3** for additional information.

2.4.4.2. Prepares written agreements (e.g., letter of agreement [LOA], memorandum of agreement [MOA], memorandum of understanding [MOU]) between airfield operations facilities and other local agencies to establish operating standards for airfield operations, as applicable.

2.4.4.3. Maintains close liaison with lateral FAA, ICAO, or host nation officials to coordinate operational changes affecting airfield operations services and operations.

2.5. AOF/DO and AOF/SO. Assists AOF/CC in execution of assigned duty responsibilities. Executes tasks as assigned by AOF/CC or higher level of command.

2.6. Airfield Management (AM). Specific duties, responsibilities and position qualification requirements for AM personnel are outlined in DAFMAN 13-204V2.

2.7. Air Traffic Control (ATC). Specific duties, responsibilities and position qualification requirements for ATC personnel are outlined in DAFMAN 13-204V3.

2.8. Radar, Airfield and Weather Systems (RAWS). Specific duties, responsibilities and position qualification requirements for RAWS personnel are outlined in DAFMAN 13-204V4.

2.9. Terminal Instrument Procedures Specialist.

2.9.1. Specific duties, responsibilities and position qualification requirements are outlined in DAFMAN 13-204V3 and AFMAN 11-230.

2.9.2. The AOF/CC appoints a TERPS specialist to manage the local TERPS program. **Note:** At locations with unit-level TERPS responsibilities, the senior operations commander or equivalent is responsible for the base TERPS program. At locations where the parent MAJCOM has unit-level TERPS responsibilities, the MAJCOM TERPS manager appoints a TERPS specialist and provides oversight of work being performed to meet unit mission requirements.

2.10. DoD Civilians. At locations with general schedule (GS) civilian airfield operations personnel assigned, managers and supervisors should review the local bargaining unit agreement available from the civilian personnel office. DAFI 36-701, *Labor-Management Relations* contains the DAF procedures and guidance for managers and supervisors when dealing with employees represented by an exclusively recognized union. It assigns responsibilities to commanders, management officials, supervisors, civilian personnel officers, labor relations officers, and staff judge advocates.

2.10.1. DoD Civilian Position Designation. Airfield operations civilian positions can be designated as Emergency-Essential or Mission-Essential. For definitions of each designation, see **Attachment 1** and applicable myFSS knowledge article located at **https://myfss.us.af.mil/USAFCommunity/s/**. See DAFI 36-129, *Civilian Personnel*

Management and Administration and DoDD 1100.4, *Guidance for Manpower Management* for additional guidance and required actions.

2.10.1.1. When filling vacant positions, AOF/CC (or equivalent) will ensure that the applicable designation statement (e.g., Mission-Essential), as listed in *Notes to Users* section of the standard core personnel document (SCPD), is added to *Other Significant Facts* section of the SCPD. **(T-1)** SCPDs for airfield operations civilian positions are contained within SCPD library located at **https://myfss.us.af.mil/USAFCommunity/s/knowledge-detail?pid=kA0t0000000LHjaCAG**.

2.10.1.2. AOF/CC (or equivalent) will request to remove known Emergency-Essential employees from their military mobilization obligation, as specified in Chapter 7 of DAFI 36-129 as well as in **Chapter 3** of DoDD 1100.4. **(T-0)**

2.10.2. DoD Civilian AM Personnel. The classification job series for AM civilians are GS-2150, *Transportation Operations* and GS-2154, *Air Traffic Assistant*.

2.10.2.1. For standardization, DoD civilian AM personnel use the following duty titles in place of the military unique duty titles (e.g., NCOIC, Deputy) throughout DAFMAN 13-204V1 thru 4: Airfield Manager (AFM), Assistant Airfield Manager (AAFM), Airfield Management Operations Manager (AMOM), Airfield Management Training Manager (AMTM) and Airfield Management Shift Lead (AMSL). Qualifications for AM civilians are found in DAFMAN 13-204V2.

2.10.2.2. When military staffing warrants, the AOF/CC may approve temporary appointments of qualified GS-2150/54s to airfield operations AM staff positions. The use of a temporary appointment should be limited in order to protect professional development opportunities for Regular Air Force personnel who require AM management knowledge and skills. **Note:** Does not apply to facilities exclusively staffed by DoD civilian personnel.

2.10.2.3. A SCPD designated for DoD civilian AM personnel, GS-2150/54-XX must be used for employment of GS-2150/54 personnel assigned to Air Force AOF positions. **Note:** Waivers/applicability of SCPD usage are contained in Chapters **1** and **2** of DAFI 36-1401, *Civilian Position Classification* and are approved by AFPC Director of Personnel Operations. For classifying AM civilian duty positions, use SCPD numbers 9G501 – Airfield Management Shift Lead, 9G502 – Assistant Airfield Manager and 9G503 – Airfield Manager. Minor modifications may be necessary to address locally assigned duties/responsibilities. Guidance for developing/modifying core personnel document(s) (CPD)/SCPDs is available in myFSS.

2.10.2.4. SCPDs for DoD civilian AM personnel also list knowledge, skills, abilities (KSA) required for designated positions. Applicants to GS-2150/54 vacant positions must address their expertise in meeting KSA criteria as part of the job application process. **(T-2)**

2.10.2.5. DoD civilian AM personnel desiring to compete for supervisory positions of AMTM, AMOM, AAFM and/or AFM are required to complete all position training requirements (if not previously completed) prior to being selected to fill the position vacancy. **(T-2)** Qualified AM civilians are also eligible to compete for positions as Air Traffic Manager/Airfield Operations Managers (AOF/CC equivalent), airspace managers and on MAJCOM/Headquarters staffs.

2.10.3. DoD Civilian ATC Personnel. The classification job series for ATC personnel is GS-2152, *Air Traffic Control*.

2.10.3.1. For clarification purposes, DoD civilian ATC personnel use the following duty titles in place of the military unique duty titles Air Traffic Manager (ATM); Controller-in-Charge (CIC); Airfield Operations Automation Manager (AOAM); ATC Training Manager (ATCTM); or Training and Standardization Manager (TSM). (Not applicable to ANG)

2.10.3.2. When military staffing warrants, the AOF/CC may approve temporary appointments of qualified GS-2152s to airfield operations ATC staff positions. The use of a temporary appointment should be limited in order to protect professional development opportunities for Regular Air Force personnel who require ATC management knowledge and skills. **Note:** Does not apply to facilities exclusively staffed by civilian controllers.

2.10.3.3. SCPDs designated for Air Traffic Control Specialist (ATCS) Terminal, GS-2152-XX must be used for employment of GS-2152 personnel assigned to Air Force AOF positions. **Note:** Waivers/applicability of SCPD usage are contained in Chapters 1 and 2 of DAFI 36-1401 and are approved by AFPC Director of Personnel Operations.

2.10.3.3.1. Only personnel who have successfully completed a formal DoD or Department of Transportation basic ATC course may be selected for GS-2152 positions. **Note:** Refer to an applicant/employee's resume to determine their current and previous work experience

2.10.3.3.2. Those working as active air traffic controllers must meet annual FAA Flying Class II medical standards. **(T-0)** See DoDI 1400.25V331, *DoD Civilian Personnel Management System: Civilian Air Traffic Controllers* for detailed guidance.

2.10.3.4. When classifying ATC civilian duty positions, use SCPDs applicable to the type of facility or position available for download from the myFSS SCPD Library. Minor modifications may be necessary to address locally assigned duties/responsibilities. Guidance for developing/modifying CPDs/SCPDs is available in myFSS.

2.10.3.4.1. SCPDs for ATCS (Terminal) also list KSAs required for designated positions. Applicants to GS-2152 vacant positions should be required to address their expertise in meeting KSA criteria as part of the job application process. Prior to being accepted for employment, GS-2152 personnel must: **(T-0)**

2.10.3.4.2. Present an ATCS or Air Traffic Safety Oversight Service credential number with a history of radar ratings, for radar positions. **(T-0)**

2.10.3.4.3. Present a Control Tower Operator certification or an Air Traffic Safety Oversight Service credential number with a history of tower ratings, for tower positions. **(T-0)**

2.10.3.5. In facilities staffed exclusively by civilian controllers, ATC civilians may progress from CIC, Watch/Crew Supervisor, AOAM, ATCTM, TSM, or ATM. Qualified ATC civilians are also eligible to compete for positions as Air Traffic Manager/Airfield Operations Managers (AOF/CC equivalent), airspace managers, TERPS managers and on MAJCOM/Headquarters staffs.

2.10.4. DoD Civilian RAWS Personnel. The classification job series for RAWS civilians is GS-0856, *Electronics Technician* and *Maintenance Supervisory/Technician*.

2.11. Civilian Career Field Managers. GS-2150/2152/2154/0856 Career Field Managers address civilian AM, ATC and RAWS personnel issues. These positions will normally be a senior civilian in GS-2150/2152/2154 job series and be appointed in writing by the Operations Civilian Career Field Manager.

2.11.1. Develop SCPDs and standard position descriptions.

2.11.2. Ensures civilian hiring authorities use correct job series and SCPDs/standard position descriptions to hire civilian airfield operations personnel. The GS-2152 job series will not be used for AM positions.

Chapter 3

OPERATION OF AIR FORCE AIRFIELDS AND AIRSPACE

3.1. Operation of Department of the Air Force Airfields and Airspace.

3.1.1. Controlled/Open Airfields. For the purposes of this manual, airfields are considered controlled and open when the control tower and/or airfield management section is open. **Note:** Depending on the FAA airspace designation, a scenario can arise where an airfield is closed and the control tower remains open to operate the assigned airspace. Refer to paragraphs **3.3** and **3.4** for detailed procedures.

3.1.2. Uncontrolled Airfields. For the purposes of this manual, airfields are considered uncontrolled when the control tower is closed. **Note:** An airfield is still considered a controlled area regarding installation security regardless of being designated as a controlled/open or uncontrolled airfield. See DAFI 31-101, *Base Defense Operations* for additional guidance.

3.1.2.1. Flight operations at uncontrolled DAF-owned and/or operated airfields require MAJCOM/A3 approval. **(T-2)** Authority may be delegated no lower than the WG/CC. The unit will address items in **Attachment 4** as part of a risk management assessment prior to requesting MAJCOM/A3 or WG/CCs (if delegated) approval. **(T-2) Note:** Recommend use of DAF Form 679 as well as DAF Form 4437, *Deliberate Risk Assessment Worksheet* to concisely communicate the information for approval and/or waiver submission. See **paragraph 1.7** for waiver requirements

3.1.2.2. Tenant and/or transient flying units require concurrence from their MAJCOM/A3 or WG/CC (if delegated) and host MAJCOM/A3 or WG/CC (if delegated) approval.

3.1.3. Flight Operations when “Essential Services” are not available. Flight Operations when essential services (i.e., fire/ crash, medical, weather, security, ATC, AM) are not available require approval of the MAJCOM/A3. Authority may be delegated no lower than the WG/CC. The unit will address items in **Attachment 4** as part of a risk management assessment prior to requesting MAJCOM or WG/CCs (if delegated) approval. **(T-2)** Recommend use of DAF Form 679 as well as DAF Form 4437 to document approval. **Note:** In addition to host MAJCOM/wing approval, tenant and/or transient flying units require concurrence from their MAJCOM/A3 or WG/CC (if delegated).

3.1.4. DAF owned and/or operated auxiliary airfields. The services available at auxiliary airfields vary according to the flying mission of the owning unit. Auxiliary airfields with control towers are considered controlled; whereas, those with runway supervisory units only are considered uncontrolled. **Note:** For the purpose of this paragraph, a control tower is defined as a facility with the required equipment and certified air traffic controllers. The unit will address items in **Attachment 4** as part of a risk management assessment prior to requesting WG/CC's approval to operate on an auxiliary airfield when essential services are not available. **(T-2)** Recommend use of DAF Form 679 as well as DAF Form 4437 to document approval.

3.1.4.1. The AFM or designated representative will work with flight safety, civil engineering squadron (CES), wing scheduling, and standardization/evaluations offices to develop an airfield inspection schedule for each active landing auxiliary airfield. **(T-2)** A joint airfield inspection should be conducted on a quarterly basis at auxiliary airfields and

include representatives from AM, ATC, wing safety, supervisor of flying (SOF), CES, and security forces.

3.1.4.2. At auxiliary airfields, a daily airfield check is required on the active landing surfaces prior to starting flying operations.

3.1.4.2.1. Airfield management personnel must use a locally developed checklist/diagram (or electronic equivalents) to conduct and document airfield checks. **(T-2)** Airfield management personnel must document and report all discrepancies and/or hazards identified during an airfield check for corrective action. **(T-3)**

3.1.4.2.2. Responsibilities for conducting airfield checks at auxiliary airfields may be delegated to non-airfield operations personnel (e.g., fire department, SOF, runway control structure personnel) that work on the airfield.

3.1.4.2.2.1. Non-airfield operations personnel performing an airfield check must be trained and certified by the AFM or designated representative. **(T-2)**

3.1.4.3. The MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations will identify as applicable, additional requirements for auxiliary airfields in their supplement to this manual.

3.1.5. Operation of Aircraft at DAF Airfields.

3.1.5.1. Military aero club aircraft are treated as government owned military aircraft. Aircraft privately owned by members of a military aero club require authorization to use military facilities IAW AFI 10-1001, *Civil Aircraft Landing Permits*, and AFI 10-1002, *Joint Use Agreements for Military and Civilian Flying Facilities*.

3.1.5.2. Civil aircraft operating at DAF airfields operate in accordance with procedures in AFI 10-1001, AFI 10-1002.

3.1.5.3. Foreign government aircraft operating at DAF airfields operate in accordance with procedures in AFI 10-1801, *Foreign Governmental Aircraft Landings at United States Air Force Installations*, and have an approved aircraft landing authorization number prior to use, except for emergencies.

3.1.6. Aircrew Violations of Airfield Restrictions. AOF/CC will process a written explanation of the incident through the host WG/CC to the WG/CC of the aircrew violating the restriction. **(T-3)** Provide an informational copy to the host MAJCOM and the MAJCOM owning the aircrew.

3.2. Airfield Operations Operating Requirements.

3.2.1. Airfield operations facilities typically operate 16-24 hours per day with assigned personnel working rotating shifts supporting the unit's primary flying mission.

3.2.2. Basic Allowance for Subsistence Authorization (BAS). Airfield operations personnel assigned to a rotating shift schedule required to perform airfield operations duties are authorized BAS due to assigned duties or unusual work hours. Refer to DoD 7000.14-*R, DoD Financial Management Regulation* for BAS policy and determination.

3.3. Published Operating Hours. Airfield operations facilities remain open to support the base flying mission, the national airspace system, and may require 24-hour operations. The 32F Capability Manpower Determinant requires operating hours be published in a MAJCOM

supplement to this manual and serves as source document for manpower authorizations. Units requesting to curtail hours must get prior approval and ensure the request (e.g., airfield closure) complies with applicable provisions in **paragraph 3.4**. The AOF/CC will ensure hours of operation are defined and operated IAW their AOI, applicable LOAs, and published in the appropriate Instrument Flight Rules (IFR) Supplement. **(T-2) Note:** Publish operating hours in a Flight Information Publication (FLIP) when designated as a part-time ATC facility IAW FAAO JO 7400.2, *Procedures for Handling Airspace Matters* and/or airfield hours differ from ATC service hours. **(T-0)**

3.3.1. Standby and On-call procedures. The senior operations commander or equivalent (delegable to SQ/CC) may authorize the use of standby and on-call procedures for airfield operations facilities. Outline applicable response time requirements, periodic equipment checks, and notification methods in a LOP. **Note:** Standby and on-call procedure usage must comply with conditions of **paragraph 3.4** (e.g., full-time ATC facilities must remain open/operational to provide continuous services).

3.3.1.1. Standby: Time when airfield operations personnel are both restricted to a designated post of duty (i.e., in facility) and are immediately available to resume operations. **(T-0)** Consider standby as duty time. **Note:** There are no response times associated with standby. Standby procedure usage as well as its definition in this instruction are derived from Title 5, Code of Federal Regulations, Part 551.431, *Pay Administration Under the Fair Labor Standards Act*.

3.3.1.2. On-call: Airfield operations personnel must be able to be contacted and available to open their post of duty (i.e., facility and/or perform required duties), within the time limit the senior operations commander or equivalent (delegable to SQ/CC) specifies. **(T-3)** Refer to DAFMAN 13-204V3, for ATC restriction and duty limitations. Do not consider on-call time as duty time.

3.3.2. Extended operating hours. The senior operations commander or equivalent (delegable to SQ/CC) may extend operating hours at bases where facilities are open less than 24 hours a day, as required, to meet short-term (no more than 30 days) mission requirements. After 30 days, airfield operations staffs must coordinate with MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations for manpower and airspace usage considerations. **(T-3)**

3.4. Curtailing Airfield Operations Services.

3.4.1. "Open". Airfield operations services are considered "open" and available during published operating hours unless a Notice to Airmen (NOTAM) is published that explicitly states which services that are unavailable. **Note:** (1) Closure NOTAMs must comply with applicable section of **paragraph 3.4** (2) When publishing closure NOTAMs, do not utilize the generic "Aerodrome closed" NOTAM as that does not explicitly address which services (i.e., Airfield, ATC facility, etc.) are unavailable.

3.4.2. "Closed". Airfield operations services are considered "closed" and unavailable during periods outside of normal published operating hours unless a NOTAM is published that states otherwise.

3.4.3. ATC Facility and Airspace Closures. In all closure instances (outside of already established and published operating hours), prior concurrence of supporting FAA facilities and NOTAM issuance is required. **(T-0)** See **paragraph 3.4.3.6** for additional requirements.

3.4.3.1. When requesting FAA acceptance of terminal airspace, the overall impact on the supporting FAA facility must be given careful consideration, with AFREP involvement, particularly when more than one DAF location/MAJCOM requires support from the same FAA Air Route Traffic Control Center (ARTCC).

3.4.3.2. Terminal ATC facilities which provide services in Class C or D airspaces have been designated/charted by the FAA as either a full-time or a part-time airspace and are required to operate IAW FAAO JO 7400.2. **(T-0) Note:** AOF/CCs and ATC facilities should reference FAAO JO 7400.2 and FAAO JO 7400.11, *Airspace Designations and Reporting Points* for additional information regarding their airspace designation and additional guidance.

3.4.3.2.1. Designated full-time airspace ATC facility/airspace closures are not authorized and must be continuously operated except for extenuating circumstances (e.g., fire or equipment failures). **(T-0)**

3.4.3.2.2. Requests for closing designated part-time airspace and its' serving ATC facilities for 96 hours or less are at the discretion of the WG/CC. Units must notify the MAJCOM airfield operations staff of facility closures per specified timelines and/or supplemental guidance. **(T-2)**

3.4.3.3. Non-Terminal ATC facilities (i.e., those not addressed by **paragraph 3.4.3.2**), which provide control services within the National Airspace System, are authorized facility closures of 96 consecutive hours or less are at the discretion of the WG/CC. **(T-3)** Units must notify the MAJCOM airfield operations staff of facility closures per specified timelines and/or supplemental guidance. **(T-2)**

3.4.3.4. For ATC Facility closure requests that exceed 96 consecutive hours, MAJCOM/A3s must approve airfield operations facility closures. **(T-2)** When delegated by the MAJCOM/A3, WG/CCs may authorize facility closures that exceed 96 consecutive hours.

3.4.3.5. The AOF/CC must notify MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations and AFREP when a proposal is under consideration to change the airspace designation or ATC service provisions within the delegated airspace, return airspace/curtail, or extend operating hours. **(T-0)** This notification will precede any negotiations outside AF channels. **(T-1) Note:** The AOF/CC should provide an informational copy to AFFSA on any proposals submitted to MAJCOM/A3s.

3.4.3.6. AOF/CCs will ensure that ATC contingency plans are developed to address support between Air Force and FAA approach control facilities in the event of an ATC facility's loss of ability (i.e., ATC-Zero) to provide ATC services. **(T-0)** Coordination of plan should be in accordance with **paragraph 4.1.2.4**. See DAFMAN 13-204V3 Chapter 7 and FAAO JO 1900.47, *Air Traffic Control Operational Readiness and Contingency Planning* for additional items to be included in ATC contingency plans.

3.4.4. Airfield Closures. MAJCOM/A3s approve airfield closures in excess of 96 consecutive hours. Airfield closures of 96 consecutive hours or less are at the discretion of the WG/CC. **Note:** WG/CCs (when delegated) may authorize airfield closures that exceed 96 consecutive hours. Units must notify the MAJCOM airfield operations staff of airfield closures per

specified timelines and/or supplemental guidance. **(T-2)** In addition, prior concurrence of supporting FAA facilities and NOTAM issuance is required.

3.4.5. Procedures for imposing airfield restrictions and closures.

3.4.5.1. MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations will establish procedures in their supplements to process (e.g., approve or deny) airfield restrictions and closures requests from subordinate bases, in addition to airfield restriction dissemination procedures.

3.4.5.2. Bases will:

3.4.5.2.1. Notify the host wing/tenant units, Numbered Air Force A3 or equivalent (if applicable), and the parent MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations airfield restrictions or closures. **(T-2)** MAJCOMS should establish procedures to notify the Tanker Airlift Control Center via **AMCA3APAirfieldClosures@us.af.mil**.

3.4.5.2.2. For approved airfield restrictions or closures that exceed 60 calendar days, send a FLIP change request to Lead Command for Aeronautical Publications Standards using the DoD FLIP Revision Report. Include pertinent data such as the effective times, dates and the approval authority. **(T-0) Note:** Lead Command for Aeronautical Publications Standards will not publish FLIP changes for airfield restrictions or closures that exist less than 60 calendar days. **(T-1)**

3.4.5.2.3. Enter approved airfield restrictions or closures into the applicable NOTAM system. Develop procedures for entering closures or restrictions into the applicable NOTAM system when the decision to close or restrict is the responsibility of a civil airport manager at shared-use airfields.

3.4.5.2.4. If a restriction can be removed before the approved expiration date, send a NOTAM canceling the restriction and notify the MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations and host wing/tenant flying units. Notify Lead Command for Aeronautical Publications Standards of the change if the restriction was published in the FLIP. **(T-1)**

3.5. Extended ATC Facility Closures or Equipment Limitations Affecting Controller Proficiency. When qualified controllers are unable to perform ATC duties for 30 or more consecutive days due to airfield closure, facility closure, or equipment limitations the following conditions will be met:

3.5.1. The AOF/CC will notify the MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations as soon as possible when a facility closure or equipment limitation is expected to exceed 30 or more consecutive days. **(T-2)**

3.5.2. The notification will include a brief description of events, expected length of facility closure, and a brief summary of anticipated use of manpower resources. **(T-2)**

3.6. Permanently Closing Runways. To permanently close a runway at an active DAF installation, the unit must:

3.6.1. Obtain MAJCOM/A3 and AF/A3O approval. **(T-1)** Provide an information copy to AFFSA/XA. **(T-3)**

3.6.2. Before the effective date of an approved closure:

3.6.2.1. Notify the AFREP in the affected FAA region. **(T-0)**

3.6.2.2. Provide AFFSA Flight Operations (**hqaffsa.xof@us.af.mil**), as the Lead Agent for Aeronautical Publication Standards, with appropriate data for FLIP documents. **(T-1)**

3.7. Activating Previously Closed Runways. Activating a previously closed runway, except for emergency situations, requires the following actions:

3.7.1. Obtain MAJCOM/A3 approval and coordinate through AFFSA for AF/A3O approval. **(T-1)**

3.7.2. Coordinate with the AFREP of the appropriate FAA region. **Note:** Bases not under FAA jurisdiction must coordinate with appropriate host government agencies. **(T-0)**

3.7.3. Provide the AFFSA Flight Operations (**hqaffsa.xof@us.af.mil**) with appropriate data for inclusion in FLIP documents. **(T-1)**

3.8. Changes in Flying Mission.

3.8.1. MAJCOMs approve subordinate unit airfield operations mission changes after coordination with AFFSA. Airfield operations mission changes may involve adjustments in manpower, equipment requirements, issues of operational impact, or military interface or services with civil or host nation operations. MAJCOMs coordinate changes in approach control services within the FAAs National Airspace System with the AFREP at the appropriate FAA region.

3.8.2. When notified of a Mission Design Series (MDS) change, the senior operations commander, with AOF/CC assistance, must ensure the following actions are taken prior to the arrival of new aircraft:

3.8.2.1. Airfield operations personnel must be trained on new MDS aircraft characteristics prior to operations commencing. **(T-2)**

3.8.2.2. Develop simulator and/or static training scenarios for Air Force controllers that emphasize integration of the new MDS aircraft operations with existing operations. **(T-2)**

3.8.2.3. Develop comprehensive pictorial and written guidance on new MDS, aircraft patterns, profiles and procedures. **(T-2)**

3.8.2.4. Review currently published instrument approach and departure procedures to ensure they will continue to meet mission requirements. **(T-2)** As necessary, develop and process new or amended instrument procedures in accordance with AFMAN 11-230.

3.8.2.5. Update existing LOPs to include procedures for new MDS aircraft. **(T-2)**

3.8.2.6. AFM coordinates with base support agencies such as Civil Engineering (CE), Fire Department, Security Forces, Wing Safety, Aircraft Maintenance, Fuels Control and Wing Plans Office to determine if a modification is required to aircraft parking plans, taxi routes, and other support facilities (e.g., pavement and infrastructure additions, waivers). **(T-2)**

3.9. Notices to Airmen (NOTAM) Verification. The AOF/CC identifies a single airfield operations facility, in writing, as the NOTAM monitor facility. The NOTAM monitor facility coordinates with AM to ensure appropriate NOTAMs are sent to facilitate airfield operations.

3.10. Unmanned Aircraft Systems (UAS) Operations. Specific procedures for local UAS operations must be published in the AOI and any other appropriate LOPs. **(T-2)** Address the procedures listed, proposal, as well as site-specific procedures/data, NOTAM requirements,

emergency recall of airspace or required landing of UAS, altitude caps, and other issues specific to base flying operations. For AM and ATC UAS procedures see DAFMANs 13-204V2 and 3 respectively. The SAA is the approval authority for UAS airfield operations. Additional resources covering varying facets of UAS procedures and programs can be found on AFFSA UAS SharePoint® **https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/affsa/SitePages/UAS_Info-Share.aspx**.

3.10.1. The safety of manned aircraft will take precedence over unmanned aircraft in an emergency situation.

3.10.2. DoD UAS Categories (Groups 1 – 5) are contained in DAFMAN 11-502, *Group(s) 1 and 2 Small Unmanned Aircraft Systems*, Attachment 2. To the maximum extent possible, airfield operations personnel will handle Group 4 and 5 UAS operations in the same manner as manned flights. Group 1, 2, and 3 UAS will generally have segregated airspace assigned to operate in that does not conflict with the normal flow of air and ground traffic.

3.10.3. UAS Pilot/Operator Airfield Operations Familiarization. When providing local airfield operations orientation training to UAS pilots/operators, consider the UAS pilot/operator qualifications when deciding on the length of training required. **Note:** Group 4 and 5 UAS pilots/operators will generally be rated pilots and have a greater understanding of airfield operations procedures compared to Group 1, 2, and 3 UAS pilots/operators.

3.10.4. Locations that support UAS operations must publish a FLIP advisory to that effect. **(T-2) Note:** This requirement is not applicable to locations conducting classified UAS operations. Example FLIP entry – "Use extreme caution for extensive UAS ops in the vicinity."

3.10.5. Airfield Markings and Signage. All changes to airfield signage/markings along established UAS taxi routes will be coordinated with UAS units prior to implementation. **(T-2)**

3.10.6. Flight Planning. A flight plan will be filed for UAS flights, as applicable. **(T-3) Note:** UAS designations in the "Aircraft Type" section of DD Form 1801, *DoD International Flight Plan* are not recognized by the ARTCC host computer. Therefore, include the UAS designation in the remarks section of all IFR flight plans. For additional guidance, see the DoD Flight Information Publication, *General Planning Guide* available for download at National Geospatial Intelligence Agency website.

3.10.7. Emergency Divert Base Designation. If designated as an emergency divert base for UAS, AOF/CC will include procedures in the AOI. **(T-2)** AOF/CC will accomplish the following:

3.10.7.1. Notify MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations if contacted to be an emergency divert base. **(T-1)**

3.10.7.2. Include procedures to notify the respective command post of any/all changes in airfield status. **(T-1)**

3.10.7.3. Include towing procedures and coordination. **(T-2)**

3.10.8. UAS pilots/operators will pre-coordinate all UAS missions with airfield operations unless addressed in an LOP. **(T-3)** UAS mission commanders, pilots, or SOFs will advise ATC of initiation and completion of flight operations. **(T-3)**

3.10.9. Contingency Operations. Establish procedures in accordance with published special instructions (SPINs). **Note:** An emergency response map should be used to develop flight

sectors for UASs. However, until an emergency response map is available, utilize the best data available for the contingency location. Additionally, traditional approach/departure corridors might not be used in a tactical environment.

3.10.10. UAS Facility Maps. UAS facility maps (UASFMs) have been developed within the FAA's National Airspace System to establish the altitude at and below which small UAS may be granted authorization for Part 107 and Section 44809 operations in controlled airspace. UASFMs are segmented into grid sections and depict the altitudes, up to 400 feet above ground level, which requests for airspace authorization can be issued without impact to operations. Additional information about UASFM guidance and associated maps can be found in FAAO JO 7210.3, *Facility Operation and Administration* Chapter 12, and on FAA website located at **https://www.faa.gov/uas/commercial_operators/uas_facility_maps**.

3.10.10.1. Procedures to Update UAS Facility Maps. Guidance for UASFM updates can be found on the AFFSA UAS SharePoint® **https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/affsa/SitePages/UAS_Info-Share.aspx**. Requests to update UASFMs will be submitted to AF/A3OJ at **af.a3ojuas.airspaceintegration@us.af.mil**. **(T-1)** AF/A3OJ will ensure that updates are made to the corresponding UASFM. **(T-1)**

3.10.10.2. AOF/CCs will ensure that UASFMs are annually reviewed in coordination with airspace manager, ATC chief controller(s), and if applicable adjacent airspace owners. **(T-0)** Results of the review will be briefed as an AOB annual review item in **Attachment 3**. At a minimum, the review should consider the following:

3.10.10.2.1. MDS changes.

3.10.10.2.2. Airspace or procedural changes.

3.10.10.2.3. Runway or airport property changes.

3.10.10.2.4. Changes in volume of aircraft traffic.

3.11. Interruptions to ATCALS. The AOF/CC ensures ATCALS are available to support the flying mission. Maintenance personnel response times/actions and preventative maintenance (PM) schedule must be established in a LOP. **(T-3)** AM submits the base PM schedule for inclusion in the FLIPs. The AOF/CC establishes procedures for reporting and coordinating ATCALS interruptions and malfunctions in a LOP. **Note:** Historical data shows that ATCALS performance can degrade over time in ways not detectable by normal preventive maintenance. Units should advise their MAJCOM of system or operational deficiencies beyond local resolution to receive assistance from their regional maintenance center (RMC). The RMCs provide remote maintenance functions, maintenance assistance, training, and engineering-level guidance. Additionally, they conduct special and commissioning system evaluations to determine the optimum system configuration (based on equipment capabilities, site limitations, mission requirements and environmental conditions). AOF/CC will accomplish the following:

3.11.1. Obtain senior operations commander or equivalent approval for ATCALS downtime outside of the published preventive maintenance inspection (PMI) schedule. Notify the AFM for appropriate NOTAM/airfield advisory action. **(T-3)** Schedule no more than one ATCALS facility for maintenance at a time. **Exception:** Multiple instrument landing system (ILS) facilities installed at opposite ends of the same runway.

3.11.1.1. Coordinate with the appropriate ARTCC, Terminal Radar Approach Control, and Flight Service Station when an ATCALS component is part of the FAAs National Airspace System and verify appropriate NOTAM action is taken. **(T-2)**

3.11.1.2. At multiple base complexes, coordinate PMI schedules so all bases do not remove similar ATCALS from service at the same time. **(T-3)**

3.11.1.3. Request planned maintenance shutdown of ATCALS during periods of least activity, including nighttime, as much as possible. **(T-3)**

3.12. Exercises. The AOF/CC participates in advance planning of wing/base exercises that involve airfield operations personnel, facilities to include ATCALS, or airfield. The purpose of this participation is to evaluate exercises for impact on airfield and flying operations. Consider traffic volume and service limitations when evaluating the impact of wing/base exercises.

Chapter 4

AIRFIELD OPERATIONS FLIGHT MANAGEMENT AND PROGRAMS

4.1. Local Operating Procedures (LOPs). AOF/CC must ensure all regulatory guidance describing local airfield operations services are published in a LOA, operations letter (OL), flight or facility operating instruction (OI) or operations plan (OPLAN). **(T-2)** AOF/CC must ensure changes to existing LOAs, MOUs, and facility OIs are converted to or integrated into the applicable LOP within 180 calendar days after the date of the memorandum. **(T-3)**

4.1.1. Approval Authority and Functional Review. The level of signature depends on the type of LOP being written or negotiated. The senior operations commander (normally the OG/CC) for the signatory agencies approves and signs for their organization.

4.1.1.1. MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations is a mandatory coordinator on LOPs (i.e., LOA, OI, OL, AOI) outlined in this chapter prior to implementation. **Note:** MAJCOMs should identify timelines and determine which LOP reviews are optional in a supplement to this manual.

4.1.1.2. LOPs that address airfield operations services, training, and/or operations with host nation agencies must be coordinated through the MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations prior to implementation. **(T-2)** This review ensures LOPs are in compliance with federal, DAF, MAJCOM, and host nation policies. **Note:** Affected MAJCOMs must establish how this process will be conducted in the supplement to this manual. Additional guidance is provided in DAFI 51-403.

4.1.2. Standard LOPs.

4.1.2.1. Airfield Driving Instruction. Refer to DAFI 13-213, *Airfield Driving* for additional information.

4.1.2.2. Airfield Operations Instruction. The AOI provides guidance regarding airfield and terminal environment activities which directly affect flying operations. It is the primary source document for describing local ATC, airfield, and flying operations applicable to base assigned aircrews, such as Visual Flight Rules (VFR) and radar traffic patterns, In-Flight Emergency response procedures and local aircraft priorities. Guidance on format and content of AOIs is provided in **Attachment 2**. The senior operations commander serves as the approval authority for the AOI. **Note:** MDS-specific instructions may direct information required in the AOI to also be published in a local 11-series instruction. AOF/CCs must work with flying standardization and evaluation offices to minimize duplication and ensure published procedures do not conflict. **(T-2)**

4.1.2.3. Training OI. Training OI is developed to establish policy and procedures for implementing and defining AM, ATC and RAWS training program responsibilities. The training OI must expand those areas where further explanation is required and standardize local training procedures. **(T-3)** Each unit must develop, implement, and administer each program in accordance with this manual. **(T-3) Note:** Units may develop a consolidated training OI. The training OI should not restate training requirements, procedures, or responsibilities already published. Additional requirements for the training OI can be found in applicable DAFMAN 13-204V2 thru 4 as well as DAFI 36-2670.

4.1.2.4. LOAs. LOAs are established between DAF units or agencies on a particular base and a non-DAF agency from the base or any unit or agency from another location.

4.1.2.4.1. The AOF/CC (delegable to facility chiefs) is the approval authority for LOAs between airfield operations facilities within their flight.

4.1.2.4.2. The unit commander (delegable to AOF/CC or equivalent) is the approval authority for LOAs between airfield operations facilities and other base agencies, or airfield operations facilities at other bases.

4.1.2.4.3. The appropriate WG/CC (delegable to the senior operations commander) is the approval authority for LOAs between DAF and non-DAF agencies. **(T-3)**

4.1.2.4.4. Routinely, LOAs are established between a supported wing and an FAA Terminal Radar Approach Control or FAA Air Route Traffic Control Center (ARTCC). LOAs with the FAA should be coordinated with the Air Traffic representative assigned as liaison with the DAF facilities involved and when applicable at the Service Area office.

4.1.2.5. OPLANs. OPLANs provide guidance for contingency/wartime operations. When applicable, airfield operations tasks are addressed in the OPLAN annex. Guidance on format and content of OPLANs is contained in AFI 10-401, *Operations Planning and Execution.* OPLANs are normally managed by the Wing Plans Office though the AOF may be appointed as the OPR for certain OPLANs pertaining to airfield operations, e.g., snow removal or stop alert plan. The AOF/CC should review all OPLANs for airfield operations tasks and prepare a plans brief that includes all airfield operations tasks in that OPLAN. The WG/CC is the approval authority for OPLANS.

4.1.2.6. Operations Letters. Operations letters are established between airfield operations facilities or between an airfield operations facility and another base agency to supplement operational or procedural instructions and to standardize operations. Operations letters describe special operating conditions or airfield operations procedures that are unique to certain locations. The AOF/CC must ensure operations letters are established covering tower/radar coordination procedures and RAWS restoral and maintenance procedures. **(T-3)** The AOF/CC is the approval authority for operations letters between airfield operations facilities; the unit commander (normally OSS/CC) is the approval authority for operations letters between airfield operations facilities and other base agencies; and the appropriate WG/CC (delegable to the senior operations commander) is the approval authority between DAF and non-DAF agencies.

4.1.2.7. Operating Instructions (OIs). OIs are considered as a directive publication and must comply with DAFMAN 90-161 publication requirements (i.e., legal review, certifying official, approving official, and the statement “COMPLIANCE WITH THIS PUBLICATION IS MANDATORY”). **(T-1)**

4.1.3. Implementing and maintaining LOPs.

4.1.3.1. Establish an effective date that allows appropriate familiarization for all affected agencies and pre-implementation actions after finalized agreement is signed. Distribute copies of the signed LOP to all affected agencies or post to the appropriate website.

4.1.3.2. Within 30 calendar days of implementing a new LOP, the AOF/CC will provide the LOP and current index to the MAJCOM. **(T-2)**

4.1.3.3. The AOF/CC will accomplish the following:

4.1.3.3.1. Review LOPs annually and update as appropriate. **(T-2)**

4.1.3.3.2. Maintain a comprehensive library of all current applicable LOPs and indexes in each airfield operations facility for use by AOF personnel. **(T-3)**

4.1.3.3.3. Include in the index, the subject/title, effective date of each LOP, MAJCOM review date, and date of annual review. **(T-3)**

4.2. Airfield Operations Board (AOB). This board provides a forum for discussing, updating, and tracking various activities associated with support of the flying mission. The AOB will convene quarterly. **(T-3)** The AOF/CC is responsible for ensuring that all items in **Attachment 3** annually reviewed. **(T-2)**

4.2.1. The board is chaired by the wing command deputy (WG/CD) or designated representative; not to be delegated lower than the senior operations commander or equivalent. **Note:** At Joint and DAF bases where the flying wing is a tenant unit, the AOI should identify whether the host (i.e., garrison) or flying mission leadership will chair the AOB.

4.2.2. Board membership will be published in the AOI, and should include the senior operations and mission support commanders or their equivalents, representation from flying and launch range organizations, wing standardization/evaluation, flight safety, OSS/CC, AOF staff (ATC, AM, NAAM, and TERPS), CES, appropriate FAA or host nation ATC facilities, unit weather applicable to airfield operations, aero club manager, command post, RAWS maintenance operations, the airspace manager, and any others as deemed necessary by the AOB chairperson.

4.2.3. The AOF/CC is the focal point for scheduling AOB meetings, preparing the agenda, and recording the minutes. The agenda includes mandatory items and any other pertinent issues the AOB chairperson deems appropriate. As a minimum, the agenda and minutes will include items listed in **Attachment 3** (as applicable to each location). **(T-3)**

4.2.3.1. Where AOBs are convened less than quarterly, the AOF/CC will continue to track activities and staff updates on briefing items listed in **Attachment 3** to the MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations on a quarterly schedule. Publish procedures/schedule in the AOI.

4.2.3.2. Distribute the agenda to board membership prior to the scheduled meeting so attendees have time to prepare for their particular discussion items. Indicate the base level OPR for each discussion item on the agenda.

4.2.3.3. AOB chairperson must sign and approve release of AOB minutes for dissemination. **(T-3)** **Note:** The AOB chairperson may delegate the authority to sign/release AOB minutes in writing to the senior operations commander or equivalent.

4.2.3.4. If there is no discussion associated with a particular mandatory item, annotate it as “N/D” in the minutes.

4.2.3.5. When AOB minutes include information from an airfield operations or Inspector General inspection report (e.g., CRITICAL or SIGNIFICANT deficiencies), the minutes must be marked Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI). **(T-3)**

4.2.3.6. Distribute AOB minutes within 20 workdays from the time the AOB convenes, to all board members and the commanders of represented base agencies, to command levels, MAJCOM, and the AFREP of the servicing FAA region. **(T-3)**

4.2.4. Refer to **paragraph A7.4.1** for AOB in and out brief guidance during an AO-CV.

4.3. AOF TRB. (Not applicable to Royal Air Force Fairford and Naval Air Station Lakehurst).

4.3.1. Airfield operations inspection discrepancies from MAJCOM or inspector general reports may be discussed in TRB minutes; however, the minutes must be marked CUI. **(T-1)**

4.3.2. Agenda. The NATCT or NCOIC, ATC Training and Standardization (TSN), NCOIC, Airfield Management Training (NAMT), and RAWS Training Manager prepares for the TRB with current data from trainees' records, facility logs, inputs from CCTLR(s), AFM and RAWS Maintenance Superintendent. At a minimum, the agenda will include the items listed in **Attachment 5** (as applicable to each location). **(T-3)**

4.4. Airfield Operations Manning. AOF/CCs closely monitors airfield operations facility manning levels to ensure uninterrupted services are provided to support the flying mission. When airfield operations facility staffing levels are forecasted to impact the local flying mission, the AOF/CC should consider the following recommendations to mitigate its impact after discussing with squadron and senior leadership (e.g., OG/CC or WG/CC). **Note:** Ensure personnel operating outside control AFSC and approval authorities are in accordance with Chapter 2 of DAFMAN 36-2100.

4.4.1. Return medically qualified personnel assigned to other base/organizational duties (such as first sergeant or chief enlisted manager) to airfield operations facilities.

4.4.2. Curtail all additional duties, (e.g., unit/organizational additional duties).

4.4.3. Exempt personnel from local exercise taskings not involving airfield operations services, (e.g., facility evacuations, facility security guards, and damage assessment).

4.4.4. During known periods of low traffic density, combine ATC positions to reduce the number of controllers on shifts to afford adequate controller staffing during peak flying periods.

4.4.5. During periods of low flying activity, pursue a waiver to the AM shift-staffing requirement.

4.4.6. Use a senior controller concept where possible for all ATC facilities during periods of non-peak flying.

4.4.7. Reduce ATC staffing to one watch supervisor (WS)/senior controller (SC) per shift unless a variance requires more.

4.4.8. Extend the ATC duty day to 10-hour shifts; or use six-one duty day rotation schedule; or reduce the wing flying schedule, commensurate with available ATC staffing. Extend AM duty day to 12-hour shifts; or use a six-one duty day rotation schedule. **Note:** To facilitate shift rotations and crew rest requirements, this activity should be forecasted at least 2 weeks or longer as outlined in local civilian labor agreement.

4.4.9. Utilize dual-certified personnel from other facilities, the facility chief controller, and all other personnel who hold certifications to work in the affected facility.

4.4.10. Cancel leave, professional military education attendance, and non-essential temporary duty (TDY).

4.5. Critical Manning Options. A facility reaches critical manning, when after implementing all actions in **paragraph 4.4** and manning is still not sufficient to support the flying mission. In those instances, the following additional actions should be taken to mitigate the impact on flying operations. These actions require the involvement and support of base leadership from the AOF/CC to the WG/CC, MAJCOM, and the FAA regional AFREP when support of adjacent FAA facilities is required. MAJCOM OPR for AOs ensure the AFREP is advised of critical manning issues that may require FAA support in their respective region.

4.5.1. Curtail ATC services, such as multiple precision approach radar capability, monitoring approaches during visual meteorological conditions.

4.5.2. Request MAJCOM relief from external visits/inspections affecting airfield operations facilities.

4.5.3. Curtail airfield operations facility operating hours and temporarily return the airspace to the FAA (or host nation), in accordance with **paragraph 3.4**.

4.5.4. NOTAM the facility closed and cease operations according to procedures agreed to in the FAA parent facility contingency plan, established in accordance with FAAO JO 1900.47.

4.5.5. Coordinate with MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations for manning assist.

4.5.6. Coordinate with unit commander/director for man-days. Refer to DAFI 36-2619, *Active Duty Operational Support (ADOS)-Active Component (AC) Man-Day Program.*

4.6. Actions Following an Aircraft Mishap. Do not disclose information related to aircraft mishaps/incidents except as outlined below.

4.6.1. The AOF/CC will coordinate on and off base mishap notification procedures to ensure appropriate base agencies and senior leadership are notified of a mishap in a timely manner. **(T-1)** To ensure ATC facilities are appropriately focused on mishap response activities and control of aircraft, only notification procedures directly associated with timely relay of data and mishap response activities should be delegated to controllers in the ATC facilities.

4.6.2. CCTLRs will develop a facility mishap notification checklist to provide mishap response guidance to controllers on duty. **(T-2)** The WS or SC initiates the checklist and ensures completion of the mishap notification checklist. Facility checklists should contain procedures for accomplishing the following items as a minimum:

4.6.2.1. Notify the CCTLR and/or AOF/CC that a mishap has occurred.

4.6.2.2. Coordinate facility and runway status with other ATC agencies.

4.6.2.3. Request an aircraft mishap local weather observation at non-automated locations or when automated systems are operating in back-up mode.

4.6.2.4. As directed, provide airspace sterilization over crash site.

4.6.2.5. Notify RAWS/RMC maintenance to check equipment performance IAW **paragraphs 4.6.5** thru **4.6.5.2**.

4.6.2.6. Initiate NOTAMs, as required.

4.6.2.7. Safeguard written facility records, including events log, position logs, flight data strips, and weather data. As soon as feasible, remove, label, store, and safeguard pertinent recorded data. Notify responsible TERPS authority so that all files contained within the instrument procedures package and any other documentation associated with the incident instrument procedure in use at the time can be preserved.

4.6.2.8. Manning permitting, provide position relief to controllers who were on duty at the time of the mishap. The WS/SC determines the optimal time for position relief, considering continuity of services for mishap response support and human factors impact on controllers on duty at the time of mishap. If the WS/SC suspects a controller may have contributed to the mishap, the controller must be relieved from position immediately. **(T-1)**

4.6.3. As soon as possible after being notified of an aircraft mishap, the AOF/CC or CCTLR will assess controller involvement. **(T-1)** If the AOF/CC or CCTLR suspects a controller's performance contributed to a mishap:

4.6.3.1. Remove the controller from ATC duties pending a flight surgeon's evaluation. Prompt evaluation by the flight surgeon is essential to accurately assess the controller's physiological condition relative to the mishap incident.

4.6.3.2. After receiving medical clearance from the local flight surgeon, assess the controller's proficiency and take appropriate certification action or return the controller to ATC duties.

4.6.4. The NCOIC, Airfield Management Operations (NAMO) will develop a mishap notification checklist to provide mishap response guidance to AM operations supervisors on duty. As a minimum, locally developed aircraft mishap (on/off base) checklists must contain the following procedures. **(T-2)**

4.6.4.1. If mishap occurred on or near the airfield, record the following items in the events log effective at the time of the mishap:

4.6.4.1.1. Runway involved.

4.6.4.1.2. Runway surface condition.

4.6.4.1.3. ATCALS status.

4.6.4.1.4. Airfield lighting status.

4.6.4.1.5. Bird watch condition.

4.6.4.2. Plot mishap location, cordon, entry control point, safe route, known hazards and other relevant information on emergency response maps.

4.6.4.3. Suspend/close operations to runways or taxiways as required.

4.6.4.4. Conduct foreign object damage (FOD) check as required. Do not touch or remove anything (e.g., FOD or debris) from the runway. Inspect aircraft taxi routes affected by the mishap.

4.6.4.5. Print current NOTAMS and send to flight safety as needed.

4.6.4.6. Obtain mishap aircraft information as needed:

4.6.4.6.1. Aircraft call sign and tail number.

4.6.4.6.2. Departure base.

4.6.4.6.3. Home station or organization.

4.6.4.6.4. Name and rank of crew members.

4.6.4.6.5. Number of personnel on board.

4.6.4.7. Safeguard and make copies of the following documents:

4.6.4.7.1. Flight Plan (weight and balance if applicable).

4.6.4.7.2. DAF Form 3616, *Daily Record of Facility Operation*.

4.6.4.7.3. Passenger manifest (if applicable).

4.6.4.7.4. Local airfield advisory information.

4.6.4.7.5. Any other forms that pertain to the flight.

4.6.4.7.6. Airfield inspection checklist as applicable.

4.6.5. When a facility, service, or ATCALS is, or is suspected of being involved in an aircraft mishap, RAWS/RMC maintenance must be notified to ensure aircraft mishap response activities are logged, to include preserving the integrity of equipment performance data. **(T-0)** Adjustments must not be made to ATCALS equipment during this inspection. **(T-0)**

4.6.5.1. Radar equipment performance checks must include scope, cursor, and map alignment. **(T-0) Note:** Not applicable to DTAS sites (i.e., STARS).

4.6.5.2. RAWS/RMC maintenance must perform an immediate and comprehensive ground check of equipment that remains in operation. **(T-0)** Since RAWS maintenance can only validate signals at ground level, a local flyability check should also be conducted to ensure appropriate airborne signal reception.

4.6.5.3. If equipment performance remains suspect, the AOF/CC will only return the facility to service after a successful FAA flight inspection. **(T-0)**

4.6.5.4. Return the facility to service, when it is suspected of contributing to a mishap incident, only after a successful FAA flight inspection. **(T-0)**

4.6.6. Establish procedures to ensure AOF personnel do not release the names of individuals allegedly involved in an aircraft incident or accident to agencies outside DAF channels. Procedures should ensure personnel do not discuss the accident/incident beyond what is necessary to accomplish duties via the crash phone. All inquiries from non-mishap response personnel must be directed to public affairs. **(T-0)**

4.6.7. The AOF/CC must notify their MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations of any mishap involving AOF services as soon as feasible without impacting emergency response activities. **(T-2)** MAJCOM OPR for AOs will coordinate with MAJCOM safety counterparts to ensure appropriate AM and ATC representation is afforded to the mishap safety investigation board (SIB), as required in DAFMAN 91-223. When the command responsible for the mishap investigation differs from the command providing host base oversight, ATC/AM representation should be provided by the command with host base oversight.

4.7. Accident Investigations Support.

4.7.1. At the request of the convening authority, AFFSA or MAJCOM OPR for AOs will support safety or accident investigations with airfield operations functional experts.

4.7.2. Personnel must complete the Aircraft Mishap Investigation Course prior to participating in aircraft accident investigations. **(T-2)**

4.8. Night Vision Device (NVD) Operations.

4.8.1. NVDs must not be used for providing separation services. NVDs are intended to enhance situational awareness only. Procedures for NVD use by airfield operations personnel or blacked-out airfield operations must be published in the AOI and/or other appropriate LOP. For guidance on AM and ATC NVD equipment use, refer to DAFMAN 13-204V2 and 3 respectively. At a minimum, the following areas must be addressed:

4.8.1.1. Scheduling procedures. **(T-2)**

4.8.1.2. Notification/coordination requirements, (e.g., publication of NOTAMs, inclusion of remarks in FLIPS). **(T-2)**

4.8.1.3. Weather/lunar illumination requirements. **(T-2)**

4.8.1.4. NVD aircraft taxi routes and NVD traffic pattern, to include pattern entry/re-entry points. **(T-2)**

4.8.1.5. Vehicle operations; participating vehicles will not be co-mingled with non-participating vehicles. **(T-2)**

4.8.1.6. Traffic pattern/flow restrictions. **Note:** Non-participating aircraft will not mix with participating NVD aircraft in any traffic pattern or on any controlled movement area. **(T-2)** Aircraft not performing NVD operations may mix with NVD aircraft only if signatory to an LOP outlining procedures with the unit performing NVD operations. The term "participating aircraft" is defined in FAAO JO 7610.14, *Non-Sensitive Procedures and Requirements for Special Operations*.

4.8.1.7. Procedures to ensure applicable aircraft/vehicle separation requirements. **(T-2)**

4.8.1.8. Termination/Restart procedures for:

4.8.1.8.1. Transitions between reduced and normal airfield lighting configurations to accommodate nonparticipating arrivals/departures. **(T-2)**

4.8.1.8.2. Emergency knock-it-off/termination procedures. **(T-2)**

4.8.1.9. Airfield lighting configurations (may vary to reflect mission/force protection requirements). **(T-2)**

4.8.1.10. Internal tower cab lighting requirements. **(T-2)**

4.8.1.11. Aircraft lighting requirements. **(T-2)**

4.8.1.12. Vehicle lighting requirements. **(T-2)**

4.9. Use of Emerging Technology on and/or around the Airfield Environment and facilities.

4.9.1. When emerging technology such as autonomous systems or other advanced technology will be used on or around the airfield environment (e.g., sUAS, counter UAS tracking systems,

and Avian/bird radars)., the AOF/CC or civilian equivalent, must ensure the following areas, as a minimum, are addressed before its use:

4.9.1.1. Impact to airfield/aircraft operations. **(T-2)**

4.9.1.2. Coordination with appropriate host nation(s) and/or joint use partner(s). **(T-0)** Ensure applicable base agencies (e.g., airfield management, air traffic control tower, safety, security forces, etc.) are coordinated with. **(T-2)**

4.9.1.3. Risk assessment. Complete the DAF Form 4437. **(T-2)**

4.9.1.4. LOP to include but not limited to:

4.9.1.4.1. Roles and responsibilities. **(T-2)**

4.9.1.4.2. System description and application/use of technology. **(T-2)**

4.9.1.4.3. Notification requirements (e.g., start and termination of use). **(T-2)**

4.9.1.4.4. Loss of link and/or control procedures. **(T-2)**

4.9.1.4.5. Phases, limitations, restrictions, radio frequency interference, and off limit areas, as applicable. **(T-2)**

4.9.1.4.6. Airfield criteria (e.g., mobile or fixed obstruction requirements and applicable waivers). **(T-2)**

4.9.1.5. Coordinate LOP with respective MAJCOM and provide a copy to AFFSA/XA prior to initial use. **(T-2)**

4.9.1.6. For use of technologies requiring additional displays for control/assist positions inside ATC facilities, refer to DAFMAN 13-204V3 for additional coordination requirements.

Chapter 5

RECORDS MANAGEMENT, INQUIRIES, AND DATA

5.1. Recorded Records. The AOF/CC or equivalent is the custodian of all recorded records in all DAF airfield operations facilities.

5.1.1. Retain all voice recorder tapes/cassettes and data extraction disc recordings for 45 calendar days, or in accordance with guidance in Air Force Records Information Management System, Air Force Records Disposition Schedule, Table 13-06., Rule 02.00, whichever is greater. **(T-2)**

5.1.2. At facilities where the ATC automation system has the ability to record operations on the system, retain all electronically recorded media (e.g., continuous data recording (CDR), digital audio tape (DAT), digital audio legal recorder (DALR) for 45 calendar days, or in accordance with guidance in AFRIMS, Air Force Records Disposition Schedule, Table 13-06., Rule 02.00, whichever is greater. **(T-2)**

5.1.3. CDR data playback/data analysis tools may be used in the investigation of an incident, suspected separation loss, pilot deviation, controller error, TCAS event, miscellaneous incident, or accident.

5.1.3.1. CDR data reductions are time-consuming activities; therefore, their retrieval should be limited to those times deemed absolutely necessary, as determined by the AOF/CC.

5.1.3.2. Copies of CDR data analyses, playbacks/files, and playback software are releasable, but only at the discretion of the AOF/CC.

5.1.3.3. Playback release procedures. For multiple sensor systems, identify the sensor in use or filter all but the primary sensor in use. In addition, identify and/or provide an electronic copy of the radar map(s) most likely in use during the event.

5.2. Retaining Mishap Records.

5.2.1. AOF/CCs file and maintain official copies of written and recorded records pertinent to an alleged flying deviation, military flying deviation or hazardous air traffic reports (HATRs) for six months. File and maintain copies of written and recorded records about aircraft mishaps or accidents for two years, or on deactivation of the unit (if sooner), according to Air Force records disposition schedule (Table 91-5**,** rule 3) located in the AFRIMS. This file may contain the originals or certified copies. In addition, keep other data such as crew duty schedules, controller training records, AF Form 1042, *Medical Recommendations for Flying or Special Operational Duty*/DD Form 2992, *Medical Recommendations for Flying or Special Operational Duty* or applicable GS-2152 medical clearance, medical waivers/profiles used in the investigation that the government might require for use in civil litigation. This file should contain only factual data that is generated in the ordinary course of business; it should not contain un-sworn controller statements, summaries of events, opinions and recommendations, or privileged safety information.

5.2.2. CDR data of automated radar systems may be used in the investigation of reported incidents believed to be operational errors/deviations to determine the amount of separation that existed or position of the aircraft. CDR data may not be used as the primary source for

reporting an incident or commencing an investigation. When CDR data is used in this capacity, the automated system clock must be verified as being accurate at the time of the incident. **(T-0)** **Note:** Protect CDR media, CDR hard-copy printouts and all other recorded records of aircraft mishaps, alleged deviations or HATR to the degree necessary to prevent unauthorized access. Locked receptacles (file cabinets, desks or safes) are adequate for storing this material.

5.3. Releasing Aircraft Mishap/Incident Related Information. Persons conducting official safety investigations have access to all factual and non-factual information pertinent to an aircraft mishap. These individuals may interview or request statements/testimony from personnel who were controlling air traffic at the time of the mishap or who observed the mishap incident. These interviews, statements and testimony are not protected from public release in all cases. See DAFI 91-204, for investigations associated with aircraft mishaps and protected information.

5.3.1. DAFI 91-204 and DAFMAN 91-223 govern the SIB process. The SIB is chartered to find causal factors and mishap prevention.

5.3.1.1. The SIB produces a two-part report. Part I of the report contains non-privileged factual information that may be disclosed outside the DAF in accordance with the Freedom of Information Act. If requested and available, CDR data may be included in Part I, Tab M. Transcripts of recorded air-to-ground and aircraft-to-aircraft communications are included in Part I**,** Tab N. Part II contains the privileged information that will not be disclosed. Investigation, Analysis, Findings, and Recommendations; Statements and Testimony of Witnesses and Persons Involved; and Statements of Persons Cited in Finding (respectively) are included in Part II, Tabs T, U, and V. Refer to DoDM 5400.07_AFMAN 33-302, *Freedom of Information Act Program* for additional information.

5.3.1.2. Distribution of privileged reports is restricted to those with a need to know and must be protected for inter-base email transmission. Refer to DAFI 91-204, for guidance on protecting privileged information.

5.3.1.3. Privileged information contained in Part II of the SIB report may not be used as evidence for punitive, disciplinary or adverse administrative actions, for determining the misconduct or line-of-duty status of any person, in flying evaluation board hearings or reviews, to determine liability or liability in claims for or against the United States, or in any other manner in any action by or against the United States. The intent of this protection is to encourage open communication without fear of retribution, in order to expedite the discovery of causal factors and prevent future incidents.

5.3.2. AFI 51-307, *Aerospace and Ground Accident Investigations* governs the accident investigation board process. An AIB conducts legal investigations of DAF aircraft accidents to prepare a publicly-releasable report and to gather and preserve evidence for use in litigation, claims, disciplinary actions and administrative proceedings. AIB investigators have access to all non-privileged testimony and evidence (factual data) pertaining to the accident including evidence contained in Part I of the formal SIB report.

5.3.2.1. The AIB investigators are provided with a list of witnesses interviewed by the SIB. The AIB may interview controllers (including SIB witnesses) and obtain controller statements or testimony. SIB witnesses can only be interviewed by the AIB after they have been released by the SIB president.

5.3.2.2. AIB investigators cannot have access to privileged testimony or statements provided to the SIB and contained in Part II of the formal SIB report. Statements and testimony made during AIB investigations may be releasable to the public. Controllers may seek legal counsel before making statements or providing testimony to the AIB.

5.3.3. FAA, National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB), and DAF investigators have access to factual records pertinent to an alleged violation of flying regulations. Requests for specific information should be routed through military commanders. These investigators may request controller statements or testimony. Controller statements and testimony made during this type of investigation are releasable to the public. Controllers may seek legal counsel before making statements or testimony to accident investigators. Do not release names of individuals involved without the specific approval of AF/A3. **(T-0)**

5.3.4. The Department of the DAF discloses its records to the public, unless these records are exempt from public disclosure. DoDM 5400.07_AFMAN 33-302, outlines procedures for disclosure of records and lists specific exemptions for withholding records. Process any non-governmental request that cites the FOIA through the wing or base FOIA office. **(T-0)**

5.3.5. All requests for release of safety information from foreign governments or their representatives, including host nation mishap investigation teams, should be referred to the Air Force Safety Center for staffing.

5.4. Removing Original Records. With the exception of official safety investigations, do not release recorded or written records concerning mishaps without authority from the senior operations commander (or designated representative/equivalent). Requests for safety investigations must be made to Wing Safety. Due to the potential for recording over or deleting original recordings, original recorded records will be retained in the AOF files and a certified transcript or certified tape copy will be released to appropriate authorities. **(T-2)** Release transcripts/voice recordings "*CUI"* to a recognized investigation authority. To ensure custodial control, written and recorded records should not be released to an intermediary collection agency that is not a member of the investigation board. If the original recording is released, keep a copy of the original recording with the custodian. **Note:** In accordance with FAA guidance, a DAT recording derived from the hard drive of the Digital Voice Recorder System is certified as an original recording.

5.4.1. At joint-use radar approach control (RAPCON) facilities, where the Air Force has furnished recorder equipment, the FAA maintains custodial control of recordings. If the Air Force requires access to a tape of one of its positions in the facility, the FAA plays back the recording. If the mishap involves an FAA controller, the FAA provides a copy of the original voice recording for the use of investigators.

5.4.2. If there is a need for a transcript or an additional tape copy, make it from the original recording. Only two certified re-recordings of the original DAT recording should be made. Any additional re-recordings should be made from a certified copy of the original. When making a tape copy include all transmissions from initial call-up to at least 5 minutes after last contact. Use a speaker-to-microphone method to copy when the equipment will not electronically connect. Preface the reproduction with "I certify this to be a true and exact (copy or transcript) of the original recording on file at this office at (base name)" (Name and Grade); (Title). Also include the date and time of reproduction, the name of the person supervising the reproduction and a certification that the reproduction is a true copy of the original recording.

5.4.3. The data extraction recordings of automated radar systems to a computer extraction disc are normally useless to a requesting party unless reduced to a printed hard-copy form. Therefore, when filling a request for computer data, the disc will be reduced to printed form unless the requesting party specifically requests the recorded data extraction. After a successful reduction to printed form, the disc may be returned to service through the normal rotation cycle unless a specific request is received to retain the disc in its entirety. The following disclaimer will be attached to any computer reproduction: "THIS DOCUMENT IS DERIVED FROM COMPUTER MAGNETIC RECORDINGS OF INTERNAL COMPUTER PROCESSING. IT IS NOT AN EXACT REPRESENTATION OF THE CONTROL POSITION DISPLAY." The printout data is considered an official record and must be retained as part of the records identified in **paragraph 5.2**. **(T-3)**

5.5. How To Prepare Transcripts.

5.5.1. Include the following in the heading of the written transcript:

5.5.1.1. Subject.

5.5.1.2. Identity of the recording facility.

5.5.1.3. List of facilities and controller positions, and the abbreviation for each.

5.5.1.4. Frequency, landline, or position being recorded.

5.5.1.5. Date and time covered by the transcript.

5.5.1.6. Source of time entries; for example, time announcer, radio broadcast, and reconstruction from timing tape.

5.5.1.7. Certification statement in accordance with **paragraph 5.4.2**.

5.5.2. Abbreviate each facility in the transcript by using the location designator, followed by the facility and control position. Identify aircraft by an abbreviated call sign if confusion will not result. Precede each transmission with the time the transmission began and identity of the transmitting source. When the source is unknown, use UNK. Single-space the body of the transcription. Double-space between each transmission. Show unintelligible transmissions by a series of asterisks. At the end of the transcript, center the statement, "END OF TRANSCRIPT".

5.5.3. Certify copies of written records or tape transcripts as follows: "I certify this to be a true and exact (copy or transcript) of the original recording on file at this office at (base name)" (Name and Grade); (Title).

5.6. ATC Forms. Refer to DAFMAN 13-204V3.

5.7. Charts, Maps, Publications and Instruction Files. Refer to DAFMAN 13-204V2, 3 and 4 for additional information.

5.8. Air Traffic Activity Reporting System (ATARS). Refer to DAFMAN 13-204V3.

Chapter 6

UNIT-LEVEL QUALITY ASSURANCE REQUIREMENTS

6.1. Unit Self-Assessment.

6.1.1. Airfield operations facility managers will conduct a continuous self-assessment using published Air Force-level SACs and SIIs located in the Management Internal Control Toolset Portal. **(T-1)**

6.1.2. Staff Assistance Visit (SAV). A unit commander may request a MAJCOM or AFFSA airfield operations SAV. Refer to DAFI 90-302 for additional information.

6.2. Cooperative Quality Assurance and Safety Programs.

6.2.1. Base Level Evaluations. Several base-level programs are designed to periodically assess the AOF's integrated participation with other agencies in supporting the wing mission. These include evaluations such as Operational Readiness Exercises/Inspections and Base Exercise Evaluations.

6.2.2. The AOF will support Wing Safety programs such as the BASH and the Mid-Air Collision Avoidance Programs. **(T-3)** Refer to DAFI 91-202, *The US Air Force Mishap Prevention Program* for details regarding these programs.

6.3. Safety Reports. DAFMAN 91-223, establishes and provides guidance for reporting Class E Airspace safety events. The intent of reporting these events is not only to identify potentially hazardous aviation practices or procedures at a local unit, but to disseminate information which might prevent similar hazardous conditions at other DAF locations. **Note**: AOFs needing to obtain records (i.e., tapes, etc.) from adjacent FAA facilities should coordinate with their AFREP to facilitate the request. AOF/CC will:

6.3.1. CMAVs. Report CMAVs and runway incursions using the DAF Form 457, *Hazard Report*. **(T-3)** See DAFMAN 91-223 for additional guidance. Report airfield infractions caused by aircraft, vehicles, or pedestrians entering the Controlled Movement Area (CMA) without specific control tower approval. **(T-3)**

6.3.2. HATRs. Report HATR events using the AF Form 651, *Hazardous Air Traffic Report (HATR)*. **(T-3)** See DAFI 91-202, DAFI 91-204, and DAFMAN 91-223 for additional guidance.

6.3.2.1. Report any air traffic or hazardous movement area occurrence that endangers the safety of an aircraft or UAS. **(T-3)**

6.3.2.2. Provide comments in the final HATR message prepared by the wing safety office when unit level AOF services are identified as contributory/causal to the HATR. **(T-1)**

6.3.2.3. If the AOF/CC concurs with the content of the HATR, simply state, "AOF/CC concurs." If the AOF/CC non-concurs, specific details of the disagreement must be identified. Comments may also be added to clarify events, for the benefit of information sharing to other airfield operations locations.

6.3.3. Runway Incursion Operational Categories. For trend and analysis purposes, all runway incursions (CMAV/HATR) are further classified into three operational categories (Operational

Error, Pilot Deviation, Vehicle/Pedestrian Deviation) as defined in **Attachment 1**. Refer to DAFI 13-213 Chapter 4 for detailed information on runway incursion reporting and documenting procedures.

6.3.3.1. The AOF/CC, AM, and safety office will work as a team to assign operational categories. **(T-1)** The AOF/CC will ensure these classifications are annotated in the recommendations section of the DAF Form 457 or the narrative section of the AF Form 651. **(T-1)**

6.3.4. The AOF/CC will notify their MAJCOM AO branches of a CMAV or HATR the first duty day following the incident. **(T-1)**

6.3.5. Civil Pilot/Procedural Deviations. Report alleged deviations by civil aircraft to the nearest general aviation district office, flight standards district office, air carrier district office or equivalent host nation agency in accordance with FAAO JO 8020.16, *Air Traffic Organization Aircraft Accident and Incident Notification, Investigation, and Reporting*. **(T-0)**

6.4. Flight Inspections. The flight inspection program verifies performance of air navigation services and associated instrument flight procedures. Flight inspection frequency, coordination requirements and profiles of procedures flown are described in AFMAN 11-225_IP, *United States Standard Flight Inspection Manual*. Coordination between affected airfield operations facility managers, RAWS personnel, and flying community is critical to ensuring successful and expedient flight inspection services. The AOF/CC will track flight inspection completion dates and subsequent evaluation requirement for all RAWS/RMC maintenance, and brief upcoming flight inspection requirements, as well as results/findings from recent inspections, at the AOB. **(T-0)**

6.5. ATC Quality Assurance. Refer to DAFMAN 13-204V3 for additional information.

6.6. Airfield Certification/Safety Inspection. Refer to DAFMAN 13-204V2 for additional information and AOF/CC responsibilities.

Chapter 7

AIRFIELD OPERATIONS PERSUANT TO CONTRACT

7.1. Applicability. This chapter applies to contracts for performance of airfield operations duties. MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations, AOF/CCs and the contracting officer's representative (COR) must ensure the SOW or PWS include the following criteria:

7.1.1. Contracts used to obtain airfield management services must require that the contractor's personnel possess required KSA to effectively manage and inspect the airfield environment for safety and compliance with established DAF, FAA, ICAO or NATO airfield planning and design criteria. **(T-1)** Specific management and technical training, experience and responsibilities for all AM positions must be published in the SOW or PWS. **(T-1)** Contracts should require personnel to already meet the minimum training and qualification requirements for each AM duty position. See DAFMAN 13-204V2, Chapter 2 for additional guidance. The contract must also state that within 12 months of assuming a position, newly hired contract personnel must complete local qualification training requirements, and the most current AM Position Certification Guide (PCG) for the duty position being filled. **(T-1) Note:** Completion of formal training courses such as the Advanced Airfield Managers Course will be at the contractor's expense. **(T-1)** AOF/CC (or equivalent) and COR should review contractor qualification requirements prior to selection of candidate and consult with MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations as needed.

7.1.1.1. The contract must specify that personnel performing the contract must be able to complete and maintain certification to operate a vehicle on the airfield, to include meeting all color vision testing requirements in order to operate a vehicle in the CMA. **(T-1)**

7.1.1.2. The contract must specify that personnel performing BASH duties under the contract must have the ability to use wildlife control devices, including firearms, as well as any other necessary equipment. **(T-1)**

7.1.1.3. Contracts for personnel selected to fill AM duty positions must also include the minimum qualification requirements outlined in DAFMAN 13-204V2. **(T-1)**

7.1.2. Contracts for air traffic control personnel selected to fill ATC duty positions, tower and/or radar, must state that the personnel must have appropriate training and experience for executing ATC duties outlined in DAFMAN 13-204V3 and this manual. Refer to DAFMAN 13-204V3 for detailed qualification and experience requirements. Contract personnel must possess required knowledge, skills and abilities to effectively promote air traffic system safety in compliance with established DAF, FAA, ICAO or NATO criterion. **(T-1)** Contracts for personnel selected to fill management/staff duty positions (CCTLR, NATCT, NSE, TSN or respective assistant positions) must state that the personnel must have supervisory and/or management level experience (e.g., training, planning, organizing and directing other personnel in ATC activities). **(T-1)**

7.1.3. More specific management training, experience, responsibilities, and duty/operational requirements will be outlined in a MAJCOM or AFFSA approved SOW or PWS or host nation agreements. **(T-2)** Where training is required, contract personnel will conduct and document training as outlined in the SOW or PWS. **(T-2)**

7.2. Responsibilities. Prior to implementation of contracts, the MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations must review and approve SOW or PWS (new and revised) that contain airfield operations services.

7.2.1. MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations will:

7.2.1.1. Act as a member of the multi-functional team for the establishment of new contracts or maintenance of existing contracts.

7.2.1.2. Review and coordinate on any new contract, proposals or amendments/modifications.

7.2.2. Units (AOF/CC) must:

7.2.2.1. Inform MAJCOM of contract and SOW or PWS proposals, developments and negotiations. **(T-2)**

7.2.2.2. Submit new contracts, proposed amendments/modifications to current contracts, quality surveillance plans and checklists to the MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations for review prior to implementing changes. **(T-2)**

7.2.2.3. Nominate a COR to ensure effective contract oversight. **(T-2)** Where AM/ATC services are provided exclusively by a contractor, the COR should possess subject matter expert (SME) knowledge of AM/ATC duties and responsibilities as contained in DAFMAN 13-204V2 and DAFMAN 13-204V3 respectively.

7.2.3. COR must:

7.2.3.1. Be appointed and trained prior to assuming COR duties. **(T-2)**

7.2.3.2. Assist contracting officer with the development of AM/ATC SOW or PWS. **(T-2)**

7.2.3.3. Perform contract quality assurance functions and manage performance (monitor, evaluate, and certify contractor compliance) in accordance with Quality Assurance Surveillance Plan. **(T-2)**

7.2.3.4. Notify the Contracting Officer of any performance deficiencies and follow-up for resolution. **(T-2)**

7.2.3.5. Review COR training as some of the requirements are based on Federal Acquisition Regulation or Defense Acquisition Regulation. **(T-0)**

Chapter 8

PROCEDURES FOR ESTABLISHING VFR FLYING AREAS AND TRAFFIC PATTERNS

8.1. VFR Traffic Patterns.

8.1.1. When designing traffic patterns, units must ensure the following:

8.1.1.1. They conform to the requirements of paragraphs 8.2 and 8.3 except when safety or noise problems require adjustments. **(T-2)**

8.1.1.2. No unusual or unnecessary maneuvering is required. **(T-2)**

8.1.2. When traffic patterns for two or more airfields are close together or overlap, units must coordinate LOAs regarding safe operations. **(T-2)**

8.1.3. Units must coordinate revised traffic patterns with ATC agencies and the MAJCOM OPR for ATC. **(T-2)**

8.2. VFR Traffic Pattern Types. Units must:

8.2.1. Establish rectangular and overhead patterns at each DAF airfield, joint-use airfield and overseas airfield controlled by the DAF, as applicable to mission needs. **(T-2)** Use LOAs to provide the desired traffic pattern at airfields under the control of foreign governments or agencies other than the DAF. **(T-3)**

8.2.2. Develop closed traffic procedures. **(T-2)** Closed traffic is a maneuver that allows an aircraft making successive patterns to stay in the normal traffic flow without exiting and reentering the pattern.

8.2.3. Bases may establish an additional rectangular pattern for light aircraft. This pattern provides adequate separation from normal rectangular and overhead pattern traffic.

8.2.4. Establish separate helicopter patterns. **(T-2)** These patterns are not necessary if the rectangular or light aircraft patterns meet operational needs without creating congestion.

8.3. VFR Traffic Pattern Altitudes. Units must establish traffic pattern altitudes by rounding to the nearest 100-foot increment relative to the published field elevation. **(T-2)** Pattern altitudes must provide a minimum of 300 feet of obstruction clearance and must be established a minimum of 500 feet above ground level after rounding is applied. **(T-2)** For example, the traffic pattern altitude for a 1,000-foot traffic pattern with a published field elevation of 250 feet would be established at 1,300 feet above mean sea level (MSL), assuming a 1,300-foot MSL altitude would provide at least 300 feet of obstruction clearance. It is recommended that units establish traffic pattern altitudes based on the following: **Note:** The traffic pattern airspace criteria depicted in FAAO JO 7400.2 and FAAO JO 7400.11 should be used to determine the area to be evaluated for obstacle clearance and pattern confines.

8.3.1. Rectangular pattern: 1,000 feet above highest field elevation (1,500 feet if a lower altitude causes a noise problem).

8.3.2. Overhead pattern: 1,500 feet above highest field elevation (2,000 feet if the 1,500-foot rectangular pattern is used or if a lower altitude causes a noise problem).

8.3.3. Light aircraft pattern: At least 500 feet above highest field elevation. In all cases, ensure adequate separation from normal rectangular pattern traffic.

8.3.4. Helicopter patterns: Establish specific altitudes that ensure adequate separation from traffic in other patterns.

8.3.5. Closed traffic: Closed traffic operations: Normally conducted at an altitude corresponding to the applicable airframe's pattern.

8.4. Environmental Impact Analysis and Air Installation Compatible Use Zone (AICUZ). Before making changes to local VFR flying areas, VFR traffic patterns or altitudes, analyze proposals for impact based on the published AICUZ study and potential environmental impact. Submit AF Form 813, *Request for Environmental Impact Analysis*, to the base civil engineering environmental planning function for approval (see Title 39, Code of Federal Regulations, Part 989, *Environmental Impact Analysis Process*, current edition and AFI 32-1015*, Integrated Installation Planning* and AFH 32-7084, *AICUZ Program Manager's Guide*. The requestor must ensure that prior to making any decision to implement the proposed change, the environmental impact analysis process is completed. **(T-0)** Advise the base civil engineer when the proposed change has been implemented.

Chapter 9

AIR FORCE RUNWAY SAFETY ACTION TEAM (AFRSAT)

9.1. Program Objectives. AFRSATs provide an objective perspective on runway safety issues such as runway incursions/excursions to reduce negative trends or unsafe conditions identified through trend and analysis, mishap reports, HATR, or hazard reports. AFRSAT visits may be directed by HAF or MAJCOM, or may be requested by individual units.

9.2. Program Scope. AFRSATs are used to analyze, report and determine corrective actions for airfield operations and support agencies for safety, compatibility and adequacy related to runway safety. AFRSAT functional experts evaluate all pertinent areas that are a part of, or affect, the negative trend or unsafe condition. This program may also be used as a mechanism to conduct a site visit for other negative safety incidents or trends that involve airfield operations. Areas include but are not limited to: near midair collision, HATRs, and Airman Safety Action Program.

9.2.1. Team Composition. Team composition is based on the area(s) being evaluated.

9.2.2. Qualifications. Individuals' qualifications (i.e., special experience identifier [SEI] or duty position) should be equivalent or one duty position higher of the area(s) being evaluated.

9.2.3. Scheduling AFRSAT Visits.

9.2.3.1. MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations schedule AFRSAT visits based on results of data analysis identifying negative trends or unsafe conditions at locations under their oversight. Notify units a minimum of 45 calendar days prior to AFRSAT visits. Schedule changes will be provided as they occur.

9.2.3.2. Wing/CC may request AFRSAT visit at any time; however, a minimum of 45 calendar days is needed to schedule the AFRSAT.

9.2.3.3. In preparation for the AFRSAT visit, the team lead will obtain all applicable documents from the unit being evaluated a minimum of 15 calendar days prior to the visit. **(T-2)** In addition, all data (mishap, accident/CMAV reports) pertaining to the AFRSAT visit will be analyzed and evaluated for trends.

9.2.3.4. Prior to the AFRSAT departing, normally the team lead will hold a preliminary meeting with team members to discuss the AFRSAT visit and the strategy for the event.

9.2.3.5. The AFRSAT will include an in-brief and out-brief to the WG/CD or their designated representative. Members in attendance should include airfield operations (AOF/CC, Tower CCTLR, AFM) flight/ground safety, radio maintenance, flying unit representatives, and individual units as applicable.

9.2.4. Evaluation. The AFRSAT will use the applicable checklist developed by AFFSA found on the AFFSA Airfield Operations SharePoint®. **(T-1)**

9.2.5. Plan. The AFRSAT will help the unit develop a plan to correct the negative trend or unsafe condition within 15 calendar days of the visit. The plan will include:

9.2.5.1. Overview of the negative trend or unsafe condition. **(T-2)**

9.2.5.2. Statistics/data supporting the negative trend or unsafe condition (Mishap/CMAV/ Accident reports). **(T-2)**

9.2.5.3. The current airport diagram displaying the location of the negative trend/unsafe condition, as applicable. **(T-2)**

9.2.5.4. A listing of problem areas and/or contributing causes to the individual events leading to the negative trend/unsafe condition. Each problem area discovered will include a recommendation to correct the problem. **(T-2)**

9.2.5.5. The designated unit within the wing who is responsible for tracking and monitoring the action items and for providing a status update to MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations every 90 calendar days or as requested. **(T-2)**

9.2.5.6. The plan will be properly designated: "CUI."

9.2.5.7. MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations will forward the plan to AFFSA within 30 calendar days of completion of the AFRSAT's visit.

9.2.6. MAJCOM OPR for airfield operations will conduct follow-up within 6 months after the AFRSAT visit. **(T-2)** A follow-up at a minimum will include a table-top review (teleconference) to discuss the status of all action items. If necessary, another site visit will be conducted. The table-top review will be documented and the results published to all attendees.

Chapter 10

CONVERTING AIRFIELD OPERATIONS SERVICES

10.1. Coordination Requirements.

10.1.1. AF/A3O is the approval authority for conversion of ATC, AM, and RAWS maintenance positions or services to DoD civilian or contract operations.

10.1.2. AOF/CC will:

10.1.2.1. Inform MAJCOM of contract and SOW or PWS proposals, developments, and negotiations. **(T-2)** Units must submit new contracts, proposed amendments/revisions to current contracts, quality surveillance plans and checklists to the parent MAJCOM for review prior to approving/implementing changes. **(T-2)**

10.1.2.2. Assign a COR in accordance with **paragraph 7.2** to ensure effective oversight. **(T-2)**

10.1.2.3. Participate in contract bid proposals and pre-award certifications with contracting squadron (or equivalent). **(T-2)**

10.1.2.4. Develop plans for contractor termination by default or walk-outs. **(T-2)**

10.1.2.5. Ensure airfield operations manpower positions are not converted to civilian/contract without MAJCOM/A3 coordination. **(T-2)**

10.1.3. MAJCOMs will:

10.1.3.1. Coordinate all proposals for competitive sourcing, contracts, or conversions of military authorizations to DoD civilians through AFFSA, to include:

10.1.3.1.1. Proposed/revised contracts and SOW or PWS dates, location, host unit, and type of aircraft served (contractor name and address, and COR name and phone number, if available).

10.1.3.1.2. Proposed timetable for transfer of manpower slots, personnel and equipment (transferred wartime tasking and personnel must be trained and ready for deployment) prior to conversion to DoD or contract services effective date.

10.1.3.1.3. Training impact statements on how converting to civilians will provide an equivalent or higher level of support.

10.1.3.2. Review and coordinate on any new contract proposals or amendments.

10.1.3.3. Review and coordinate on plans for contractor termination by default or walk-out.

10.1.3.4. Maintain copies of the contract for each contracted location.

10.1.4. AFFSA will evaluate contract proposals and forward to AF/A3O for approval.

10.2. ATC Contracting. At all locations within the National Airspace System, the DAF and FAA have agreed that the DAF may contract only VFR control towers with low density traffic operations. The DAF may not contract IFR facilities. The ANG is responsible for contracting tower services at ANG locations and will notify AFFSA when contracting new facilities.

ADRIAN L. SPAIN, Lt Gen, USAF
Deputy Chief of Staff, Operations

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

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DAFMAN 13-204V3, *Air Traffic Control*, 26 April 2024

DAFMAN 13-204V4, *Radar, Airfield and Weather Systems*, 13 May 2024

DAFMAN 36-2100, *Military Utilization and Classification*, 7 April 2021

DAFMAN 36-2806, *Military Awards: Criteria and Procedures*, 27 October 2022

DAFMAN 36-2689, *Training Program*, 31 March 2023

DAFMAN 90-161, *Publishing Processes and Procedures,* 18 October 2023

DAFMAN 91-223, *Aviation Safety Investigations and Reports*, 20 September 2022

AFI 10-401, *Operations Planning and Execution,* 19 July 2024

AFI 10-1001, *Civil Aircraft Landing Permits,* 23 August 2018

AFI 10-1002, *Joint Use Agreements for Military and Civilian Flying Facilities,* 8 August 2018

AFI 10-1801, *Foreign Governmental Aircraft Landings at United States Air Force Installations,* 25 Sep 2018

AFI 32-1015, *Integrated Installation Planning*, 30 July 2019

AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program,* 23 March 2020

AFI 38-101, *Manpower and Organization*, 29 August 2019

AFI 51-307, *Aerospace and Ground Accident Investigations*, 18 March 2019

AFMAN 11-225_IP, *United States Standard Flight Inspection Manual,* 1 April 2015

AFMAN 11-230, *Instrument Procedures,* 24 July 2019

AFMAN 32-1040, *Civil Engineer Airfield Infrastructure Systems*, 23 August 2019

AFH 32-7084, *AICUZ Program Manager's Guide,* 2 November 2017

AFTTP 3-4.13V2, *Contingency Airfield Operations*, 28 January 2022

UFC 3-260-01*, Airfield and Heliport Planning and Design*, 4 February 2019

FAA Order JO 1900.47, *Air Traffic Control Operational Readiness and Contingency Planning,* Current Edition

FAA Order JO 7110.65, *Air Traffic Control*, Current Edition

FAA Order JO 7210.3, *Facility Operation and Administration*, Current Edition

FAA Order JO 7400.2, *Procedures for Handling Airspace Matters,* Current Edition

FAA Order JO 7400.11, *Airspace Designations and Reporting Points*, Current Edition

FAA Order JO 7610.14, *Non-Sensitive Procedures and Requirements for Special Operations*, Current Edition

FAA Order JO 8020.16, *Air Traffic Organization Aircraft Accident and Incident Notification, Investigation, and Reporting*, Current Edition

FAA Order 8200.1, *United States Standard Flight Inspection Manual*, Current Edition

Prescribed Forms

None

Adopted Forms

DD Form 1801, *DoD International Flight Plan*

DD Form 2992, *Medical Recommendations for Flying or Special Operational Duty*

DAF Form 457, *Hazard Report*

DAF Form 623A, *On-The-Job Training Record – Continuation Sheet*

DAF Form 679, *Department of the Air Force Publication Compliance Item Waiver Request/Approval*

DAF Form 797, *Job Qualification Standard Continuation/Command JQS*

DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*

DAF Form 3616, *Daily Record of Facility Operation*

DAF Form 4437, *Deliberate Risk Assessment Worksheet*

AF Form 483, *Certificate of Competency*

AF Form 651, *Hazardous Air Traffic Report (HATR)*

AF Form 813, *Request for Environmental Impact Analysis*

AF Form 1042, *Medical Recommendations for Flying or Special Operational Duty*

Abbreviations and Acronyms

AAFM—Assistant Airfield Manager (Civilians Only)

ADPM—Airfield Driving Program Manager

AF—Air Force

AF/A3O—Air Force Director of Current Operations

AFI—Air Force Instruction

AFFSA—Air Force Flight Standards Agency

AFFSA/XA—AFFSA Airfield Operations Division

AFFSA/XR—AFFSA Programs and Requirements Division

AFM—Airfield Manager

AFMAN—Air Force Manual

AFPD—Air Force Policy Directive

AFR—Air Force Reserve

AFREP—Air Force Representative

AFRIMS—Air Force Records Information Management System

AFRSAT—Air Force Runway Safety Action Team

AFSC—Air Force Specialty Code

AFTTP—Air Force Tactics, Techniques and Procedures

AICUZ—Air Installation Compatible Use Zone

AM—Airfield Management

AMOM—Airfield Management Operations Manager

AMSL—Airfield Management Shift Lead

AMTM—Airfield Management Training Manager (Civilians Only)

ANG—Air National Guard

AOAM—Airfield Operations Automation Manager

AOB—Airfield Operations Board

AO-CV—Airfield Operations Compliance Verification

AOF—Airfield Operations Flight

AOF/CC—Airfield Operations Flight Commander

AOF/DO—Airfield Operations Flight Director of Operations

AOF/SO—Airfield Operations Flight Systems Officer

AOI—Airfield Operations Instruction

AOM—Airfield Operations Management

AOSS—Airfield Operations System Specialist

ARTCC—Air Route Traffic Control Center

ASR—Airport Surveillance Radar

ATARS—Air Traffic Activity Reporting System

ATC—Air Traffic Control

ATCALS—Air Traffic Control and Landing Systems

ATCS—Air Traffic Control Specialist

ATCTM—ATC Training Manager

ATIS—Automatic Terminal Information Service

ATM—Air Traffic Manager

BAS—Basic Allowance for Subsistence

BASH—Bird/Wildlife Aircraft Strike Hazard

BWC—Bird Watch Condition

CC—Commander

CCTLR—Chief Controller

CDR—Continuous Data Recording

CE—Civil Engineering

CES—Civil Engineering Squadron

CFETP—Career Field Education and Training Plan

CFM—Career Field Manager

CIC—Controller in Charge

CMA—Controlled Movement Area

CMAV—Controlled Movement Area Violation

COR—Contract Officer's Representative

CPD—Core Personnel Document

CUI—Controlled Unclassified Information

DAF—Department of the Air Force

DAFI—Department of the Air Force Instruction

DAFMAN—Department of the Air Force Manual

DAFPD—Department of the Air Force Policy Directive

DALR—Digital Audio Legal Recorder

DAT—Digital Audio Tape

DD Form—Department of Defense Form

DNIC—Duties Not to Include Controlling

DoD—Department of Defense

DTAS—Digital Terminal Automation Systems

EDIT—Experiencing Difficulty In Training

FAA—Federal Aviation Administration

FAAO—Federal Aviation Administration Order

FLIP—Flight Information Publication

FOD—Foreign Object Damage

FOIA—Freedom of Information Act

GCA—Ground Controlled Approach

GS—General Schedule

HATR—Hazardous Air Traffic Report

IAW—In Accordance With

ICAO—International Civil Aviation Organization

IFR—Instrument Flight Rules

IG—Inspector General

IGEMS—Inspector General Enterprise Management System

ILS—Instrument Landing System

JO—Joint Order

KSA—Knowledge, Skills and Abilities

LAANC—Low Altitude Authorization and Notification Capability

LOA—Letter of Agreement

LOP—Local Operating Procedure

MAJCOM—Major Command

MDS—Mission Design Series

MOA—Memorandum of Agreement

MOU—Memorandum of Understanding

MSG—Mission Support Group

MSL—Mean Sea Level

NAAM—NCOIC, Airfield Automation Manager

NAMO—NCOIC, Airfield Management Operations

NAMT—NCOIC, Airfield Management Training

NATCT—NCOIC, Air Traffic Control Training

NATO—North Atlantic Treaty Organization

NCOIC—Noncommissioned Officer-In-Charge

NOTAM—Notice to Airmen

NSE—NCOIC, ATC Standardization and Evaluation

NTSB—National Transportation Safety Board

NVD—Night Vision Device

OG—Operations Group

OG/CC—Operations Group Commander

OI—Operating Instruction

OJT—On the-Job Training

OL—Operations Letter

OPLAN—Operations Plan

OPR—Office of Primary Responsibility

OSS—Operations Support Squadron

PCG—Position Certification Guide

PEC—Program Element Code

PM—Preventative Maintenance

PMI—Preventive Maintenance Inspection

POM—Program Objective Memorandum

PPR—Prior Permission Required

PWS—Performance Work Statement

QAE—Quality Assurance Evaluators

RAPCON—Radar Approach Control

RAWS—Radar, Airfield, and Weather Systems

RCR—Runway Condition Reading

RFC—Radar Final Control

RMC—Regional Maintenance Center

RSC—Runway Surface Condition

SAA—Senior Airfield Authority

SAC—Self-Assessment Checklist

SAV—Staff Assistance Visit

SC—Senior Controller

SCPD—Standard Core Personnel Document

SEI—Specialty Experience Identifier

SIB—Safety Investigation Board

SII—Special Interest Item

SME—Subject Matter Expert

SOF—Supervisor of Flying

SOW—Statement of Work

SPIN—Special Instructions

STARS—Standard Terminal Automation Replacement System

TCAS—Traffic Alert and Collision Avoidance System

TDY—Temporary Duty

TERPS—Terminal Instrument Procedures

TRB—Training Review Board

TSM—Training and Standardization Manager

TSN—NCOIC, ATC Training and Standardization

UAS—Unmanned Aircraft System

UASFM—UAS Facility Maps

UMD—Unit Manning Document

UNK—Unknown

US—United States

USAF—United States Air Force

VFR—Visual Flight Rules

WADPM—Wing or Delta Airfield Driving Program Manager

WG/CC—Wing Commander

WG/CD—Wing Command Deputy

WS—Watch Supervisor

Terms

Advanced Airfield Manager Course—This course provides training for selected Air Force personnel the knowledge and skills needed to perform the duties of the Airfield Manager. This is an advanced AM course designed primarily for the Air Force Senior NCO Airfield Manager. Other potential candidates for this course include Air Force Airfield Operations Flight Officers, Air Force civilian Airfield Managers, Civil Engineering Community Planners, Flying Safety Officers, as well as civilian contractors performing AM duties (to be approved on case-by-case basis).

Aerodrome—A defined area on land or water (including any buildings, installations and equipment) intended to be used either wholly or in part for the arrival, departure, and movement of aircraft.

Aircraft Mishap Investigation Course—This course provides instruction on aircraft mishap investigations and analyses of human and material factors to personnel who will be primary members on Class A & B flight mishap investigation boards.

Airfield Check—Conducted by airfield management personnel to the examine the primary takeoff, landing and taxi surfaces in response to in-flight or ground emergencies, Runway Surface Condition or Runway Condition Reading assessments, Foreign Object Damage removal, and for Bird/Wildlife Aircraft Strike Hazards and Habitat control.

Airfield Facilities—Includes runways, taxiways, aircraft parking and servicing areas, ATC facilities, airfield management operations, RAWS, aircraft fire suppression and rescue services, airfield lighting systems and systems to hold or stop aircraft (where required).

Airfield Inspection—Conducted by airfield management personnel to identify discrepancies and/or hazards on the airfield (e.g., signs, markings, lighting, pavements, aircraft arresting system, obstructions, obstacles, construction areas).

Airfield Management (AM)—A function that conducts airfield inspections and checks for safety and compliance with planning and design criteria. Plans, organizes and directs airfield activities to include airfield construction/repairs, airfield driving program, ice/snow removal operations,

bird/wildlife control. Procures, maintains, and produces information on safe operation of aircraft through the national and inter space system such as flight information publications, aeronautical charts and maps, notice to airmen (NOTAM), local airfield and navigational aid status, and weather information. Processes domestic and international flight plans. Coordinates with base agencies to meet aircrew requirements for refueling and transient aircraft maintenance.

Airfield Operating Hours—The hours of airfield operations as published in the MAJCOM supplement.

Airfield Operations Compliance Verification (AO-CV)—Inspection measuring personnel, equipment, and procedures directly involved in the operational effectiveness of airfield operations facilities.

Airfield Operations Instruction (AOI)—Formerly known as the base flying regulation. Defines local procedures for airfield management and ATC.

Air Traffic Control and Landing Systems—Department of Defense facilities, personnel, and equipment (fixed, mobile, and seaborne) with associated avionics to provide safe, orderly, and expeditious aerospace vehicle movements worldwide.

Approach End of Runway—That end of a runway nearest to the direction from which the final approach is made.

Air Traffic Control (ATC) Duty—ATC duty is defined as controlling live or simulated traffic, monitoring a trainee controlling live or simulated traffic, issuing ATC movement and control messages, monitoring a trainee issuing ATC movement and control messages, or conducting duties as a watch supervisor.

Career Field Education and Training Plan (CFETP)—CFETP is a comprehensive core-training document that identifies: life-cycle education and training requirements, training support resources, and minimum core task requirements for a specialty. The CFETP aims to give personnel a clear path and instill a sense of industry in career field training. This document is the formal training contract between the Air Force career field manager and AETC for formal accession and life-cycle skills training.

Computer Based Training—Student conducted training through lessons received at a computer terminal and via computer interaction.

Closed—An airfield is "closed" when no flying activity is permitted. If the closure is for a particular type of aircraft or operation, it must be so stated. For example: "Closed to aircraft not involved in Volant Rodeo."

Controlled Movement Area (CMA)—As defined in airfield operations instructions, any portion of the airfield requiring aircraft, vehicles and pedestrians to obtain specific ATC approval for access (normally via two-way radio contact with the control tower). Controlled movement areas include but are not limited to areas used for takeoff, landing and as required taxiing of aircraft. **Note:** This definition is used in lieu of "movement area" as defined in the FAA Pilot Controller Glossary which can be found on the FAA website: **https://www.faa.gov/air_traffic/publications/media/PCG_10-12-17.pdf**.

Controlled Movement Area Violation (CMAV) Event—An airfield infraction caused by aircraft, vehicles, or pedestrians entering the control movement area without specific control tower

approval. This definition includes runway incursions and infractions caused by communication errors. Refer to DAFMAN 91-223 for HATR and CMAV reporting procedures.

Control Tower Operator (CTO)—Includes local control, ground control and flight data positions at contract tower locations.

CRITICAL Deficiency—Any deficiency that clearly indicates actual impact on current flight safety.

Emergency Essential Civilian Positions—Positions that are positions that are located overseas or that would be transferred overseas during a global crisis, or which requires the incumbent to perform temporary duty assignments overseas during a global crisis in support of a combat operations or the availability of combat-essential systems in accordance with Section 1580 of Title 10, U.S.C.

External Stores—Items mounted on the external portions of an aircraft (e.g., armament, fuel tanks, baggage pods) that can be released or jettisoned from an aircraft.

Field Command—A major subdivision of the USSF that is assigned a key part of the USSF mission. A field command is directly subordinate to the Office of the Chief of Space Operations (Space Staff), which is part of the Headquarters of the Department of the Air Force. All USSF field commands report to the CSO.

Full-Time Airspace—Airspace designation that will remain operational for continuous (24/7) operations. Once the full-time surface area (either Class C or D airspace) is established, the servicing ATC facility is required to remain operational (open and manned) barring unanticipated extenuating circumstances, e.g., fire or equipment failures which should be addressed in an appropriate Letter of Agreement.

Foreign Object Damage/Debris Check—Conducted by AM personnel prior to start of normal flying activities or in response to FOD reports by SOF, control tower or pilot.

Gatekeeper Process—The process in which MAJCOM IG and Wing IG POCs facilitate optimum scheduling for inspections, evaluations, assessments, and other inspection-related visits conducted by outside entities.

Ground Controlled Approach (GCA)—A fixed, mobile, or transportable facility that provides radar arrival and RFC services within airspace designated by an approach control facility.

Host Wing Commander—The individual with ultimate responsibility for operating the airfield.

Hot Spot—A runway safety related problem area or intersection on an airfield. Typically it is a complex or confusing taxiway/taxiway or taxiway/runway intersection. A confusing condition may be compounded by a miscommunication between a controller and a pilot, and may cause an aircraft separation standard to be compromised. The area may have a history of surface incidents or the potential for surface incidents.

Joint Facility—Air traffic control facility that divides responsibilities between the Air Force and another military or civil agency.

Joint-Use Airfield—An Air Force installation where agreements exist among the Air Force and host nation authorities for joint-use of all or a portion of airfield facilities.

Local Operating Procedure (LOP)—Supplemental procedures issued as letters of agreement, operations letters, operating instructions, memorandum of understanding, squadron regulations, operations plans, or base manuals or instructions.

Lost Link—UAS pilot/operator has lost the ability to provide real-time control of the UAS. Loss may be permanent or temporary.

Major Command (MAJCOM)—For the purpose of this manual, includes all Air Force Major Commands plus the Air National Guard Readiness Center, Air Force Reserve Command, Direct Reporting Units, and Field Operating Agencies.

MAJCOM IG Gatekeeper—MAJCOM IG and Wing IG POCs who facilitate optimum scheduling for inspections, evaluations, assessments, and other inspection-related visits (including audits and inquiries) conducted by outside entities (Office of the IG, Department of Defense [OIG, DoD] Government Accountability Office [GAO], and others).

MINOR Deficiency—A validated deficiency which indicates non-compliance with regulatory requirements.

Mishap—A mishap is an unplanned occurrence, or series of occurrences, that results in damage or injury and meets Class A, B, C, D or Class E event reporting criteria in accordance with DAFI 91-204. Damage or injury includes: damage to DoD property (excluding normal wear and tear or aging); occupational illness to DoD military or civilian personnel; injury to DoD military personnel on or off-duty; injury to on-duty DoD civilian personnel; damage to public or private property, or injury or illness to non-DoD personnel caused by Air Force operations.

Mission—Essential Civilian Position—Positions that are based on positions that perform Mission Essential Functions which are defined as: those functions that enable an organization to provide vital services, exercise civil authority, maintain the safety of the general public, and sustain the industrial/economic base during disruption of normal operations. ME positions are positions that must continue in the advent of a disruption of normal operations.

Mission Design Series (MDS)—The official designation for aerospace vehicles used to represent a specific category of aerospace vehicles for operations, support, and documentation purposes.

On-call—Employees will be designated in an on-call status in a prearranged rotational order based on skill specialty and leave SCD. Employees required to report for duty are compensated according to the applicable pay and overtime rules.

On-the-Job Training (OJT)—Hands-on, over-the-shoulder training conducted to certify personnel in both upgrade and job qualification training.

Part-Time Airspace—Airspace designation that does not operate 24/7/365, published in FAAO JO 7400.11 with statement identifying designation "Airspace area is effective during the specific dates and times established by a Notice to Airmen. The effective date and time will thereafter be continuously published in the Airport/Facility Directory". Hours will be published in applicable FLIPs. Facilities that support this type of airspace are authorized to close IAW FAA and DAFMAN 13-204V1 criteria.

Position Certification—An endorsement by the NCOIC, ATC Standardization and Evaluation/Assistant NCOIC, ATC Standardization and Evaluation/NCOIC, ATC Training and Standardization/Assistant NCOIC, ATC Training and Standardization or Control Tower Operator

examiner that the applicant has demonstrated the competence, qualifications and skill required to operate at a specific position.

Precision Approach Radar (PAR)—Radar displaying range, azimuth, and elevation (in relation to a glide slope) normally encompassing an area from 10 to 20 miles on final approach to a position on the runway intercepted by the glide slope.

Prior Permission Required (PPR)—The airfield is closed to transient aircraft unless approval for operation is obtained from the appropriate commander through airfield management. PPR must be requested and approved before the flight departs to that airfield. The purpose of PPR is to control volume and flow of traffic rather than to prohibit it. Prior permission is required for all aircraft requiring transient alert service outside the published transient alert duty hours. All aircraft carrying hazardous materials must obtain prior permission.

Qualified Controller—An individual who is (1) facility rated and holds a minimum classification of GS-2152, 13M3, PAFSC 1C252 or PAFSC 1C131 and (2) has been awarded a 053, 056, or 364 SEI or an equivalent level of experience/training as specified earlier in this manual for the award of the aforementioned SEIs, or (3) is position certified but already meets aforementioned classification and SEI requirements.

Radar Approach Control (RAPCON)—A fixed, mobile, or transportable radar facility that provides approach control, arrival and RFC services using surveillance radar.

Radar Final Control (RFC)—An air traffic control service that provides navigational guidance or approach monitoring during the final approach phase of flight. This service normally includes precision approach radar (PAR) approaches, instrument approach monitoring using precision approach radar equipment when final approach courses are coincident, flight following, airport surveillance radar (ASR) approaches and safety alert services. Additional services are provided within system capability. A controller assigned to the radar final control position (called the radar final controller) normally provides this service.

Radar Final Control Facility—A fixed, mobile, or transportable radar facility that provides radar final control service. (PAR rating required for award of SEI.)

Runway Condition Reading (RCR)—A numerical decelerometer reading relayed by air traffic controllers at Air Force and certain civil bases for use by the pilot in determining runway braking action. These readings are routinely relayed only to Air Force and Air National Guard Aircraft.

Runway Control Structure—A portable or fixed shelter where non-air traffic control personnel observe arriving and departing aircraft. The unit is near the active runway, and has two-way air-ground communications.

Runway Incursion—Any occurrence at an aerodrome involving the incorrect presence of an aircraft, vehicle or person on the protected area of a surface designated for the landing and takeoff of aircraft. For the purpose of this instruction, the protected area is the same as the CMA. Runway incursions have the potential to result in aircraft endangerment and loss of life. While there are several factors involved in a runway incursion, the leading causes of these incidents result from failure to follow procedures, inadequate vehicle operator training, and loss of situational awareness. These are further classified into three operational categories:

1) Operational Error (OE)—A failure of the air traffic control system that results in loss of separation.

2) Pilot Deviation (PD)—The action of a pilot that results in the violation of ATC instructions, AFIs and/or FARs.

3) Vehicle/Pedestrian Deviation (V/PD)—Any entry or movement on the controlled movement area by a vehicle (including aircraft operated by non-pilots) or pedestrian that has not been authorized by air traffic control.

Runway Surface Condition (RSC)—Identifies the condition of the runway surface when covered with slush, snow, ice or water.

Senior Airfield Authority (SAA)—The SAA is an individual appointed by the component responsible for airfield operations at the direction of the joint force commander. The SAA is responsible for the control, operation, and maintenance of the airfield, to include deployable air traffic control and landing systems, the runways, associated taxiways, and parking ramps, as well as air, land, safety surfaces, and facilities of which proximity affects airfield operations.

Senior Operations Commander—The senior commander (or equivalent), normally held by OG/CC, responsible for airfield operations.

Shared Use—An airfield used by both civil and military flight activities that are located at a civil airport under control of civil authorities.

SIGNIFICANT Deficiency—Any deficiency which could have an adverse effect or impact to flight safety.

Skill Level—The level of qualification within an awarded Air Force specialty, shown by the fourth digit of the Air Force Specialty Code.

Specialty Experience Identifier (SEI)—A three-character code that identifies special experience training identified in the personnel data system. Specialty Experience Identifiers may permit rapid identification of individuals with special qualifications to meet peacetime assignments. They provide a means for identifying critical manning requirements during wartime or contingency operations when little lead time is available for training personnel in specific technical skills.

Standby—An employee is on duty, and time spent on standby duty is hours of work if, for work-related reasons, the employee is restricted by official order to a designated post of duty and is assigned to be in a state of readiness to perform work with limitations on the employee's activities so substantial that the employee cannot use the time effectively for his or her own purposes. A finding that an employee's activities are substantially limited may not be based on the fact that an employee is subject to restrictions necessary to ensure that the employee will be able to perform his or her duties and responsibilities, such as restrictions on alcohol consumption or use of certain medications.

Stop Training—When a trainee is unable to accomplish knowledge based (including classroom instruction), simulator (including static scenarios), and OJT due to unforeseen events or inability to meet standards.

Supervisor of Flying (SOF)—A rated officer authorized by the flying unit commander to monitor and supervise current flight operations. A Supervisor of Flying may perform duties from the control tower.

Task—A unit of work activity or operation that forms a significant part of a duty. A task usually has clear beginning and ending points and directly observable or measurable processes, frequently

but not always resulting in a product that can be evaluated for quantity, quality or fitness in the work environment. A task is performed for its own sake; that is, it is not dependent upon other tasks, although it may fall in a sequence with other tasks in a duty or job array.

Attachment 2

AIRFIELD OPERATIONS INSTRUCTION (AOI) REQUIREMENTS

A2.1. AOI. All applicable items in this attachment must be addressed in the base AOI. **(T-3)** **Note:** Specific procedures may be outlined in a separate local directive; however, that directive must be referenced in the base AOI.

A2.1.1. General Information Regarding Airfield Facilities.

A2.1.1.1. Runway(s) and Taxiways: Airfield Diagram depicting runway/taxiway designations, runway(s) length, width and surface type, field elevation/gradient, designation of primary instrument runway, depiction of critical areas, intersection departure distances, and instrument hold lines.

A2.1.1.2. Runway Selection Procedures.

A2.1.1.3. Control of Ground Traffic in the Controlled Movement Area (CMA): Publish CMA diagrams and entry access/exit procedures in the AOI. **(T-1)** Procedures must require specific ATC approval for entry onto CMAs and require direct two-way radio communication. **(T-1)** When direct two-way radio communication is not possible, procedures for use of light guns, light signals or escorts must be specifically outlined in an LOP. **(T-1)** Local guidance must include procedures to reposition personnel to a safe distance from the CMA and to recall personnel from controlled movement areas in the event of a tower/vehicle radio failure. **(T-1)**

A2.1.1.4. Airfield Lighting Systems.

A2.1.1.5. Permanently Closed/Unusable Portions of the Airfield.

A2.1.1.6. Aircraft Arresting Systems. Describe the type, location and standard configuration and coordination procedures for aircraft arresting systems. Use easy-to-understand descriptions such as "operational, not-operational", “configured, not-configured” and "in-service, out-of-service" consistently when reporting system status.

A2.1.1.7. Parking Plan/Restrictions.

A2.1.1.8. Air Traffic Control Facilities: Operating Hours and Designated Airspace.

A2.1.1.9. Local Frequencies/Channelization.

A2.1.1.10. RAWS, to include Preventive Maintenance Inspection (PMI) schedule.

A2.1.1.11. Transient Alert: Services/Facilities Available to Support Transient Aircraft.

A2.1.1.12. Automatic Terminal Information Service (ATIS) Procedures.

A2.1.1.13. Aircraft Special Operations Areas/Ramps: Arm/De-Arm Areas, Engine Run-up Areas, Drag Chute Jettison Areas, Hot Pit Refueling Areas, UAS Designated Start Areas.

A2.1.1.14. Aircraft Towing Procedures.

A2.1.1.15. Aircraft Taxiing Requirements/Routes (to include Heavy Aircraft Jet Thrust Avoidance Procedures, Taxiway/Taxilane Restrictions and Wingtip Clearance).

A2.1.1.16. Airfield Maintenance: Sweeper Operations, Grass Mowing.

A2.1.1.17. Runway Surface Condition (RSC) and/or Runway Condition Reading (RCR) Values.

A2.1.1.18. Procedures/requirements for conducting runway inspections/checks.

A2.1.1.19. Procedures for Opening and Closing the Runway.

A2.1.1.20. Procedures for Suspending and Resuming Runway Operations.

A2.1.1.21. Engine Test/Run-up Procedures.

A2.1.1.22. Noise Abatement Procedures.

A2.1.1.23. Procedures for Protecting Precision Approach Critical Areas.

A2.1.1.24. Restricted/Classified Areas on the Airfield.

A2.1.1.25. Auxiliary power for ATCALS facilities.

A2.1.1.26. Drone Operations (i.e., Part 101 and Part 107) as applicable.

A2.2. Flying Areas.

A2.2.1. Local Flying Area/Designation of Airspace.

A2.2.2. VFR Local Training Areas.

A2.3. VFR Procedures.

A2.3.1. VFR Weather Minimums.

A2.3.2. VFR Traffic Patterns.

A2.3.3. Special Procedures (Helicopter, Functional Check Flight, Paradrop Operations, 360-Overhead Pattern Protection).

A2.3.4. Reduced Same Runway Separation Procedures.

A2.3.5. Intersection Departures.

A2.4. IFR Procedures.

A2.4.1. Radar Traffic Patterns.

A2.4.2. Availability/Restrictions for Surveillance (ASR) Approaches and Precision Approach Radar (PAR) Approaches/Monitoring.

A2.4.3. Local Departure Procedures.

A2.4.4. Radar Vector to Initial Procedures.

A2.5. Emergency Procedures.

A2.5.1. Operation of the Primary Crash Alarm System and Secondary Crash Net.

A2.5.2. Emergency Response Procedures: In-Flight/Ground Emergency Procedures (On/Off Base).

A2.5.3. External Stores Jettison Area Procedures.

A2.5.4. Fuel Dumping.

A2.5.5. Emergency Aircraft Arresting System Procedures.

A2.5.6. Hot Brake Area and Procedures.

A2.5.7. Abandonment of Aircraft (Controlled Bail-Out, Ejection, Plotting Aircraft Coordinates).

A2.5.8. Personnel/Crash Locator Beacon Signal/Emergency Locator Transmitter (ELT) response procedures.

A2.5.9. Jammed/Hung Ordnance Procedures.

A2.5.10. Wind Limitations on Control Tower.

A2.5.11. Evacuation of Airfield Operations Facilities.

A2.5.12. Other Emergency Procedures as Locally Determined (flame out, precautionary approaches).

A2.5.13. Alternate Facility Procedures.

A2.6. Flight Planning Procedures.

A2.7. Miscellaneous Procedures.

A2.7.1. Airfield Operations Board (AOB) membership.

A2.7.1.1. Publish items that require annual review in the AOI.

A2.7.1.2. Annotate each item with the month in which the items will be reviewed.

A2.7.2. NOTAM Procedures.

A2.7.3. Flight Information Publication (FLIP) Accounts, Procedures for Requesting Changes.

A2.7.4. Prior Permission Requested (PPR) Procedures.

A2.7.5. Air Evac Notification and Response Procedures.

A2.7.6. Unscheduled/Unauthorized Aircraft Arrivals.

A2.7.7. Distinguished Visitor Notification Procedures.

A2.7.8. Dangerous/Hazardous Cargo.

A2.7.9. Airfield Photography.

A2.7.10. Night Vision Device (NVD) Operations.

A2.7.11. Local Aircraft Priorities.

A2.7.12. Lost Communications Instructions.

A2.7.13. Standard Climb-Out Instructions.

A2.7.14. Opposite Direction Take-Offs and Landings.

A2.7.15. Breakout/Go Around/Missed Approach Procedures.

A2.7.16. Civilian Aircraft Operations.

A2.7.17. Civil Use of Military ATCALS.

A2.7.18. Aero Club Operations.

A2.7.19. Weather Dissemination and Coordination Procedures: Hazardous/Severe Weather Notification Procedures; Lightning Response.

A2.7.20. Airfield Snow Removal Operations.

A2.7.21. Bird/Wildlife Control: Local Bird/Aircraft Strike Hazard (BASH) Program Guidelines.

A2.7.22. Bird Watch Conditions: Locally established Bird Watch Conditions (BWC).

A2.7.23. Supervisor of Flying (SOF) Operating in the Tower.

A2.7.24. Tactical Arrival/Departure Procedures.

A2.7.25. UAS Operations Procedures.

A2.7.26. Contractors working on the airfield.

A2.7.27. Non-standard airfield systems or configurations (e.g., signs, lighting, markings, arresting gear)

Attachment 3

AIRFIELD OPERATIONS BOARD (AOB) BRIEFING ITEMS

A3.1. Distribute the agenda to board membership prior to the scheduled meeting, so attendees have time to prepare for their particular discussion items. Indicate the base-level OPR for each discussion item on the agenda.

A3.2. The following items will be briefed quarterly:

A3.2.1. Airspace (terminal, enroute, and special use airspace). **(T-3)**

A3.2.2. ATC/flying procedures (new, revised, rescinded and seldom used). **(T-3)**

A3.2.3. Military, FAA, or host nation concerns. **(T-3)**

A3.2.4. Airfield operations flight (AOF Staff, AM, ATC, and RAWS) staffing. **(T-3)** Report airfield operations staffing as: authorized, assigned, and available by AOF Staff and facility (e.g., tower, RAPCON/GCA/RFC, and AM section). **(T-3)** Report unqualified apprentice ATC/AM/RAWS personnel in overall numbers. **(T-3)** Consider personnel as unavailable when they are on long term DNIC status, suspended, deployed, pending withdrawal, separating, or PCS, and those personnel TDY (more than 2 weeks), assigned or detailed outside their primary AFSC longer than 30 calendar days.

A3.2.5. RAWS (flight inspection schedule, ATCALS equipment findings, status, upgrades). **(T-3)**

A3.2.6. Airfield Environment: Review airfield activities, status of construction projects, number and status of permanent/temporary airfield waivers, results of quarterly joint inspection, and the status of deteriorating airfield/runway conditions. **(T-3)** Include "completed" "on-going" and "future" projects. Include airfield manager assessed priorities in the event of variance funded/unfunded CES projects listing. **(T-3)**.

A3.2.7. HATRs. Provide a brief summary of (airfield operations related) HATRs reported in the period preceding the current AOB being conducted. **(T-3)**

A3.2.8. Status of Airfield Driving Training Program. **(T-3)**

A3.2.8.1. Units visited and results of inspection. **(T-3)**

A3.2.8.2. Units scheduled for the upcoming quarter. **(T-3)**

A3.2.8.3. Number of spot-checks performed and results. **(T-3)**

A3.2.8.4. Changes or findings with accomplishing airfield driver training. **(T-3)**

A3.2.8.5. Other issues as appropriate.

A3.2.9. Runway intrusions/Controlled Movement Area Violations (CMAVs): All CMAVs, including HATRs, regardless of impact on flight safety, must be briefed and documented in the AOB minutes. **(T-3)** Provide a detailed description of each incident to include (who, what, when, where and how, type vehicle/aircraft involved and action taken to prevent a reoccurrence). Highlight any trends. **(T-3)** Compare current and past year's number of runway intrusions by quarter.

A3.3. The following items will be briefed annually:

A3.3.1. LOP Review. Review the listing and effective dates of LOPs affecting the local airfield/flight environment (AOI, LOAs, operations letters, OPLAN taskings as applicable to the airfield environment, host nation agreements).

A3.3.2. TERPS. Conduct reviews of all instrument procedures to validate the continuing need for each. In addition to the annual requirement, review procedures when changes occur.

A3.3.3. Air Installation Compatible Use Zone (AICUZ). (optional item.) The AOB provides an optimal forum for conducting a review of the local AICUZ Program, as required by AFI 32-1015, *Integrated Installation Planning*.

A3.3.4. Results of annual self-inspection.

A3.3.5. Special Interest Items (SII). Report the results of new Air Force and/or MAJCOM SII checklists, including SIIs carried over from the previous year, at the first AOB following the official release of the SII checklist.

A3.3.6. Results of the annual airfield certification/safety inspection and auxiliary airfield inspection (if applicable).

A3.3.7. Aircraft Parking Plan: Review annually or as required.

A3.3.8. Status of existing airfield waivers with emphasis on temporary waivers and associated correction plans in accordance with UFC 3-260-1, *Airfield and Heliport Planning and Design* section B1-2.2.

A3.3.9. UAS Facility Map. Conduct a review of listed altitudes in the UASFM in coordination with airspace manager, tower chief controller, and if applicable adjacent airspace owners.

Attachment 4

OPERATIONAL RISK MANAGEMENT CONSIDERATIONS FOR OPERATIONS WHEN ESSENTIAL SERVICES ARE NOT AVAILABLE

A4.1. Operational impacts.

A4.1.1. Cost/benefit of operating a controlled versus uncontrolled airfield.

A4.1.1.1. Diverting aircraft if not controlled.

A4.1.1.2. Utilizing PPR/other local processes to exercise control of arriving aircraft under uncontrolled situations.

A4.1.1.3. Telephone stand-by/on-call status options.

A4.1.2. How mishaps would affect "next day" Air Force operations. **Note:** Air Force must wait for NTSB to investigate civil aircraft accidents.

A4.1.3. Delay of routine runway maintenance tasks.

A4.1.4. Pattern restrictions (i.e., one-in, one-out; practice approaches).

A4.2. Security implications.

A4.2.1. Physical security.

A4.2.1.1. Airfield access and ground traffic control.

A4.2.1.2. Potential theft and sabotage/vandalism.

A4.2.2. Operational security: intelligence exploitation.

A4.3. Safety implications.

A4.3.1. Possible mishap potential increase.

A4.3.2. Uncontrolled taxi operations by operators unfamiliar with procedures and facilities.

A4.3.3. Possible mix of uncontrolled military and civil traffic.

A4.3.4. Potential for delay in fire, crash, medical or rescue responses.

A4.3.5. Potential for injury to maintenance personnel on the airfield.

A4.3.6. Public exposure to hazardous/dangerous activities.

A4.3.7. Increased potential for runway incursions.

A4.3.8. Procedures for conducting airfield inspections and checks in accordance with this manual.

A4.4. Legal implications.

A4.4.1. Accountability for incidents and accidents.

A4.4.2. Liability for injury and damage.

A4.4.3. Distinguishing between authorized and unauthorized landings.

A4.5. Other areas.

A4.5.1. Procedures for operating airfield lighting, if applicable.

A4.5.2. Notification and radio communication procedures.

A4.5.3. Weather reporting procedures.

A4.5.4. Host nation consideration (as applicable).

A4.5.5. If approved, WG/CC will ensure that the following actions are taken:

A4.5.5.1. If implemented on a short term basis (30 calendar days or less):

A4.5.5.1.1. Arriving aircraft will coordinate their arrival for accountability/identification purposes.

A4.5.5.1.2. Issue pertinent NOTAMs.

A4.5.5.1.3. Coordinate provisions for airfield security.

A4.5.5.1.4. Coordinate emergency response procedures.

A4.5.5.2. If this is implemented on a long term basis (e.g., more than 30 calendar days). **Note:** Address the items in **paragraph A4.5.5.1** in the AOI, enroute supplement, and area planning 1, as appropriate.

Attachment 5

AOF TRAINING REVIEW BOARD BRIEFING ITEMS

A5.1. Indoctrination Process. Identify all individuals involved in base, squadron, and facility indoctrination programs to include the estimated completion dates. Identify the status of the initial evaluation to include any items found deficient and the method used to report the deficiency.

A5.2. Five-Skill Level Upgrade Training. Identify all apprentice personnel involved in upgrade training. Information must include training start dates, position of training, block of training (as applicable), certifications obtained, upgrade training issue date with estimated completion date (AM only), training calendar days remaining in the position and status of trainee progression, and estimated completion date.

A5.3. Seven-Skill Level Upgrade Training. Identify all journeyman personnel involved in upgrade training. Information must include status of trainee progression (e.g., 7-level course status, PCG status) and project completion.

A5.4. Qualification Training. Identify all personnel involved in position and management training, to include 13M, AFM, AOSS, NAAM and TERPS. Information will include position certifications obtained, current training position, training calendar days remaining and status of training progression.

A5.5. Controller Proficiency. Identify controller proficiency on all rated personnel (including staff).

A5.6. Status of Trainees in Other Categories. Identify personnel experiencing difficulty in training (EDIT), stop training, suspensions and withdrawals. Identify the reason for the category and corrective actions being taken, where applicable. Additionally, track assigned personnel and their number of days working outside of the career field.

A5.7. Automated Training Programs. Identify the status of ATC simulation equipment, local SharePoint (if applicable), and other computer-based delivery systems. Simulation information should include availability of the system, down time, findings/deficiencies, hours of usage and new programs, if available.

A5.8. DAF Form 623A, *On-The-Job Training Record – Continuation Sheet* Status. Discuss the results of monthly training record reviews. Report discrepancy and documentation trends.

A5.9. ATC Non-Radar Training Program. Identify the status of the non-radar training program to include non-radar proficiency training, development of new non-radar simulator scenarios, new procedures affecting non-radar training and any adverse trends in non-radar operations.

A5.10. Status of Facility Training Programs. Identify any regulatory changes received from MAJCOM and/or HAF, certification guide development and implementation and feedback received from flight personnel. Discuss any proposed changes necessary to improve the training program. This agenda item allows each member of the board to discuss the quality of training products, professional development and outstanding practices.

A5.11. Quality Assurance. The NSE and NAMO will identify the quality of service provided to aircraft and other customers. **(T-3)** Quality assurance information includes facility crew

evaluations results, aircrew surveys, duty position certifications, proficiency test results, and certification tests results and other information garnered during the reporting period.

A5.12. RAWS Training.

A5.12.1. Upgrade training status for on-call qualification, phase of training (1-5), time in phase, Air Force Job Qualification Standard and Air Force Qualification Training Package.

A5.12.2. Continuation training for all members with start date, projected completion date, training milestones, and training status.

A5.12.3. Personnel evaluations of all members with time on station, past evaluation date/status, projected evaluation date, and remarks.

A5.12.4. Current SEI 264 assigned personnel, initial certification date, recertification date.

A5.13. Open Items. Identify all items that were carried over from the previous month's board for corrective measures. Include the open item, point of contact, plan of action, estimated completion date and whether the item is closed or open for the next board meeting.

Attachment 6

SAMPLE AFRSAT REPORT

Table A6.1. Sample AFRSAT Report.

CUI (When filled)

UNITED STATES AIR FORCE

RUNWAY SAFETY ACTION TEAM REPORT

Blank AFB, 27-31 July 2010

CUI (When filled)

Section I - Executive Summary

Purpose and Scope:

This AFRSAT visit was initiated as a result of Blank AFB having the third highest number of runway incursions in 2009. It included: an evaluation of management of the airfield driving program; air traffic and flight procedures; airfield infrastructure, squadron airfield driving program manager (ADPM) and wing safety. This report includes recommendations proposed to the Wing/CC to help reduce the number of runway incursions.

Overview: Blank AFB has adequate procedures in place to promote runway safety. All units and agencies interviewed displayed a high level of experience and knowledge of the runway incursion problem. Personnel expressed significant interest in reducing the number of runway incursions, and welcomed any inputs by the team. Blank AFB is a 24/7 airfield, averaging more than 55K runway operations per a year. There are multiple types of aircraft missions; helicopter operations, unmanned aircraft, fighter and mobility operations. Assigned aircraft include C-130s, and B-1s.

Wing Leadership: The wing leadership is keenly aware of their runway incursion trend and have aggressively implemented several measures that have already shown progress in reducing the number of runway incursions. The following actions have been taken:

1. Installed runway guard lights at taxiway Hotel at Runway 36 and repainted airfield markings

2. Created a runway incursion board to evaluate runway incursions and make recommendations for improvements.

3. Initiated project to build perimeter road around the approach end of Runway 24.

Airfield Configuration: Blank AFB has three runways: runways 18R/36L, 18L/36R and 6/24. Runway 6/24 is the primary instrument runway. Runway 6 and 36L cross each other at their approach end. Aircraft must taxi across runway 36L on taxiway Hotel to get to the approach end of Runway 6 and normally taxi down Runway 6 to takeoff the full length of runway 36L. This particular intersection (36L & Hotel) contributed to 45% of all runways. Another “hot spot” for runway incursions is access to the Army Ramp on the south side of the airfield. For vehicles to get to where

the Army helicopters are parked, drivers must cross the approach end of Runway 24. This runway crossing contributed to 45% of all runway incursions. See airfield diagram (**Figure A6.4)**, Attachment 1.

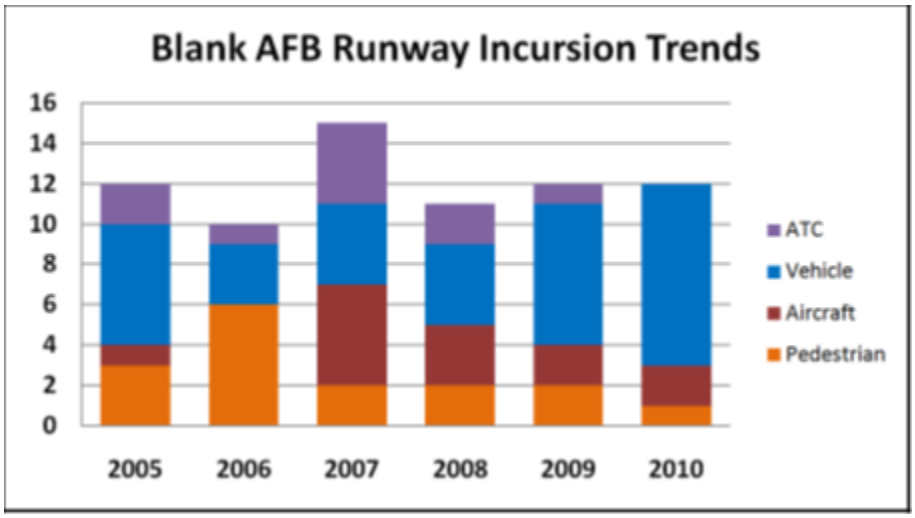
Air Traffic Control: The control tower provides excellent view of all runways. The height of the Control Tower, and its location from the runways are adequate. An almost constant flow of aircraft and vehicular traffic emphasize the need for positive control and keen situational awareness by the controllers. Controllers received additional training on controlled movement area violations (CMAV)/runway incursions, and incorporated a — "Lessons Learned" document for all controllers to review in the facilities recent information file. Controllers are keenly aware of the runway incursion potential and pay particular attention to runway crossing procedures to ensure the safety of operations while meeting the flying mission requirements.

Airfield Management: Airfield Management is effectively managing the airfield driving training program and airfield safety. The airfield manager and deputy airfield manager have taken positive steps to improve training of airfield drivers and improve airfield markings and signs. Runway incursions are briefed at the airfield operations board. The wing's airfield driving program is extremely large and challenging with 40 units. Currently, airfield management tests all airfield drivers. On average more than 200 personnel are tested each month. There were several areas discovered should be improved on the airfield to include airfield markings and signs. The airfield driving training program was adequate, however several changes are recommended to improve the overall management of the program and the training of airfield drivers.

Airfield Driving Program Managers: The team evaluated 20 unit airfield driving training programs and found that 20% were not managing their program in accordance with local guidance. More than 50 drivers were checked for AF Form 483, *Certificate of Competency* and several drivers were discovered did not have them. The units ADPMs were notified and an investigation into those organizations found several problems with personnel in-processing, lack of supervision involvement and program management.

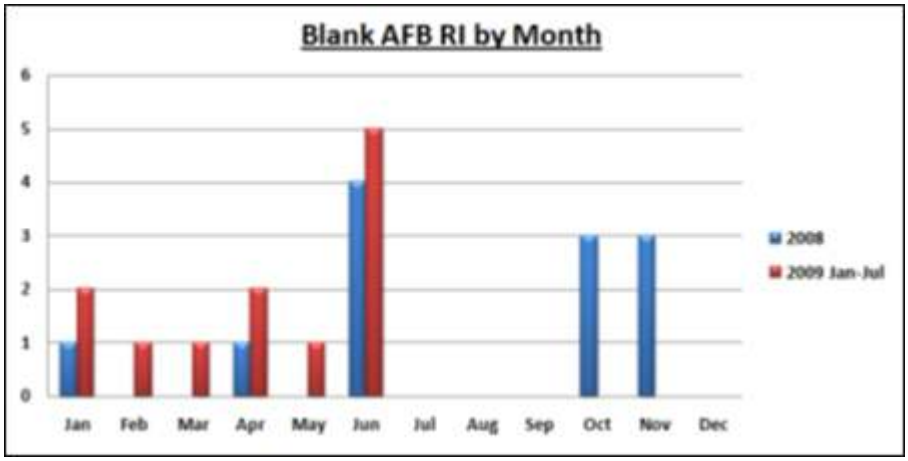
Section II – Trend Analysis
A thorough analysis was conducted of all CMAVs and HATRS runway incursions that occurred over the past five years. **See Figure A6.1.** In 2009, Blank AFB had a 9% increase in the number of runway incursions from 2008. Thus far in 2010, there have already been 12 runway incursions with five months left in this year.

Figure A6.1. Blank AFB Runway Incursion Trends.



A6.1. Historically: The months of June, September, and November are peak months for runway incursions. These time frames appear to be high traffic periods due to scheduled exercises and the influx of new and inexperienced airfield drivers significantly contributes to the increase in incursions. **See Figure A6.2**.

Figure A6.2. Runway Incursions by Month.



A6.2. Similar to Air Force Trend Data: aircraft maintenance, security forces and civil engineering have committed the most runway incursions on the airfield (54%). These organizations have the majority of the airfield drivers and due to the airfield layout are required to cross the runways at several locations to perform their duties. There are currently no specialized briefings or training provided to these high risk AFSCs. **See Figure A6.3**.

Figure A6.3. Blank AFB 2008- 2009 Runway Incursion Violators.

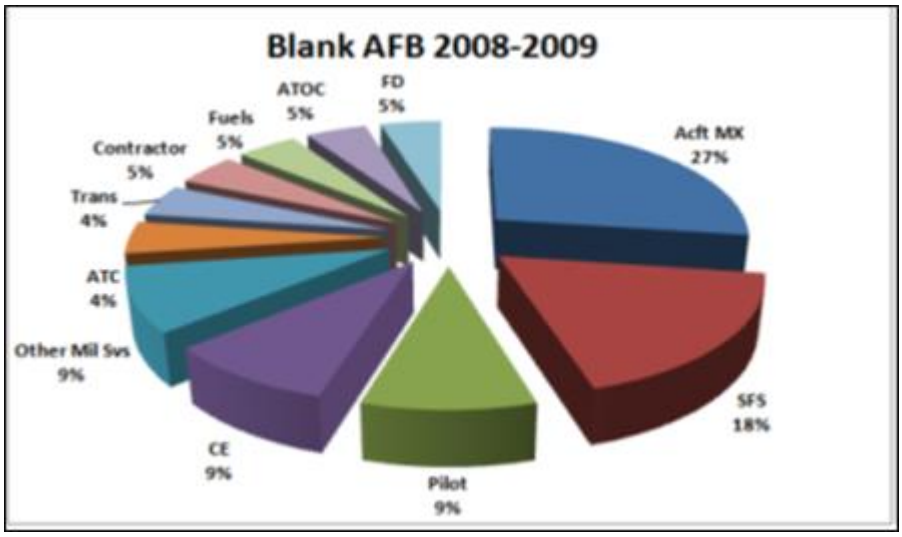


Table A6.2. Problems and Recommendations.

Section III - Problems and Recommendations

Airfield:

1. Problem: Internal lighting for several runway hold position signs was inoperative for extended periods. Taxiway A1 is missing a runway hold sign. Also, the runway hold sign is not collocated with the runway hold marking at several locations. Work orders and NOTAMs are submitted to correct/mitigate these problems.

Recommendation: Immediately repair runway hold signs. Ensure a bench stock of replacement parts is available to repair frequent outages. Install runway hold sign on taxiway A1. Ensure a runway hold sign is installed adjacent to all runway hold lines.

2. Problem: Several runway hold line markings are faded, non-reflective or barely visible on taxiways leading to runway 18L/36R. In addition, several old runway hold lines have been blacked out instead of being removed, thus leading to confusion on where the actual hold lines are located. In accordance with AFMAN 32-1040, *Civil Engineer Airfield Infrastructure Systems*, runway hold lines cannot be blacked out, they must be removed.

Recommendation: As required, repaint new runway hold lines and markings for Runway 18L/36R and other taxiways and aprons. Immediately contract or gain the capability to remove old runway hold lines. Consider power washing runway hold line markings that are barely visible due to dirt obscuring the marking.

Air Traffic Control:

3. Problem: Several phraseology errors were consistently noted. Specifically, phraseology pertaining to observed abnormalities and intra-facility coordination for runway crossings.

Recommendation: Increased training and facility management oversight is required to reduce and identify these coordination and phraseology errors. Ensure phraseology used is in accordance with FAAO JO 7110.65, Chapters 2-7, 9 and 10.

4. Problem: Construction floodlights create a glare in the Control Tower reducing visibility of controllers.

Recommendation: CE and airfield operations must ensure there is close coordination with the Control Tower before starting construction projects using floodlights for night operations.

Airfield Management:

5. Problem: Procedures are not developed for contractor personnel to receive training on airfield safety and airfield driving requirements before work can commence on the airfield.

Recommendation: Ensure these procedures are delineated in airfield construction contracts.

6. Problem: There is limited use of local resources to educate/inform airfield users on runway incursion prevention.

Recommendation: Utilize local resources, base paper, bulletins, commander's channel, locally developed posters/advertisements to provide updates, promote runway incursion prevention and lessons learned information to airfield drivers.

Airfield Driving:

7. Problem: Training criteria and procedures for issuing AF Forms 483 are not included in the current airfield driving instruction.

Recommendation: Immediately rewrite the airfield driving instruction and ensure compliance with DAFI 13-213.

8. Problem: Not all airfield drivers are completing all local training required by local Airfield Driving Instruction or supplemental messages. The Blank AFB Airfield Driving PowerPoint slide presentation and training video are not clearly delineated as required training item for all airfield drivers.

Recommendation: Immediately provide all official training material to ADPMs. Ensure all training requirements are specifically identified in Blank AFB Airfield Driving Instruction, to include any local video training, PowerPoint slides.

9. Problem: Not all vehicles operating in the Controlled Movement Area (CMA) have mobile radios installed in the vehicle.

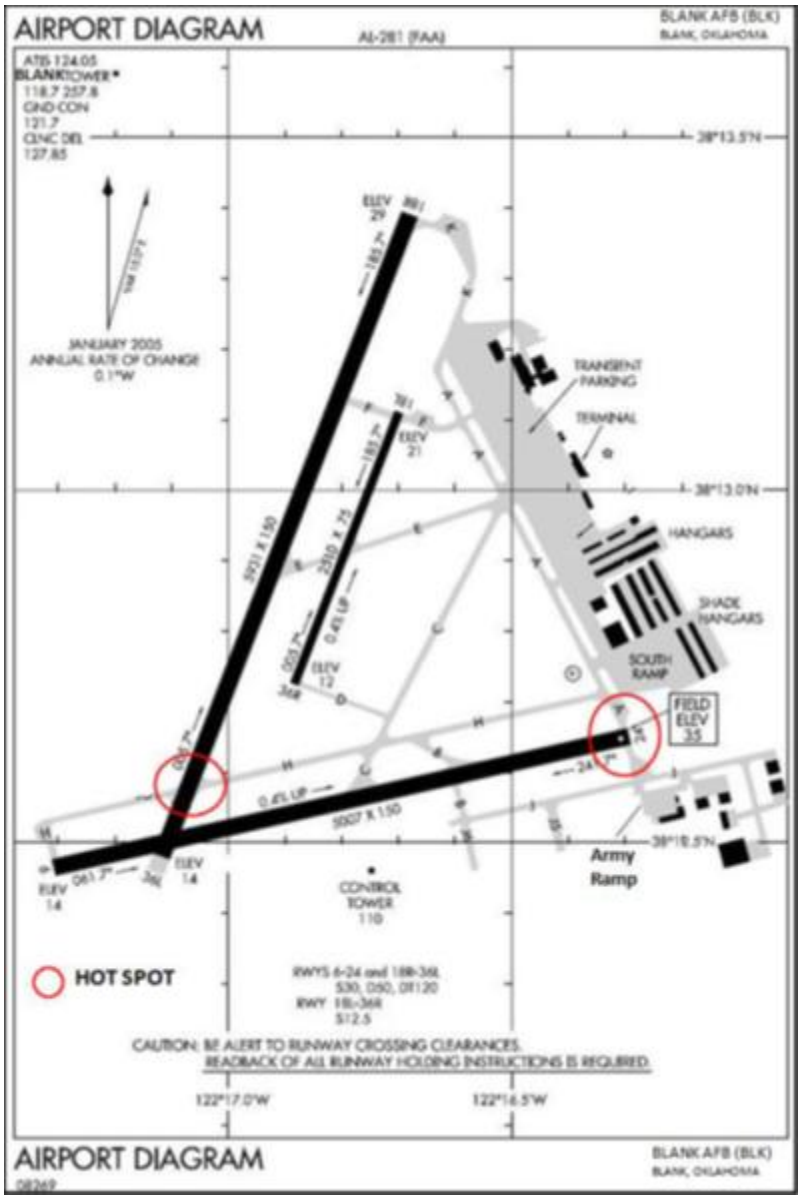
Recommendation: To the maximum extent possible, require the installation of mobile radios in all vehicles that routinely operate in the CMAs. Use handheld radios as a backup. Ensure all personnel who operate a vehicle on the runway and CMA are trained on how to operate radios and effectively communicate with ATC.

10. Problem: No checklists are being used to complete the day and night orientations or practical airfield drivers test.

Recommendation: Develop and utilize a checklist for airfield driver trainers to use when conducting the airfield driving orientations and practical driving test. A checklist will ensure all airfield drivers are shown all required areas of the airfield and complete all required training during practical drivers test.

Section IV - Personnel	Lt Col Alexander
Contacted	OSS/CC
Col Jackson	Lt Col Smith
FTW/CC	AMS/DO
Lt Col Handgrove	Mr. Woods
FTW/SE	306 OSAM
Capt Pitt	Maj Borne
AOF/CC	306 SFS/CC
Mr. Thomas	
306 OSAT	

Figure A6.4. Airport Diagram.



Attachment 7

AIRIELD OPERATIONS COMPLIANCE VERIFICATION (AO-CV)

A7.1. AO-CV Overview. The AO-CV evaluates the ability of the air traffic system (e.g., AOM, ATC, AM, RAWS) to meet safety standards and operational requirements of military and civil users. The objective is to analyze and evaluate pertinent airfield operations functional areas for safety and operational compliance. The AO-CV provides the means to resolve identified deficiencies at the appropriate command echelons and offers MAJCOMs and units a means of self-evaluation and improvement. MAJCOMs can then analyze trend data derived to continuously improve AO policies or procedures.

A7.1.1. Guiding Regulations.

A7.1.1.1. Memorandum of Agreement Between the Department of Transportation, Federal Aviation Administration, and the U.S. Army-Navy-Air Force (Appendix 4-2) located within FAAO JO 7610.14, *Non-Sensitive Procedures and Requirements for Special Operations*.

A7.1.1.2. USAF ATC (e.g., staffing, qualifications, certifications, performance, procedures) is governed by FAAO JO 7110.65, *Air Traffic Control*, FAAO JO 7610.14 and implemented through portions of DAFMAN 13-204V3.

A7.1.1.3. USAF Airfield Management (e.g., equipment, staffing, qualifications, performance, procedures) operations are governed by DAFMAN 13-204V2, and DAFI 13-213.

A7.1.1.4. USAF Radar, Airfield, and Weather Systems (e.g., equipment, staffing, qualifications, performance, procedures) are governed by FAAO JO 7610.14, FAAO 8200.1, *United States Standard Flight Inspection Manual*, and implemented through portions of DAFMAN 13-204V4.

A7.1.1.5. USAF airfield operations (e.g., equipment, staffing, qualifications, performance, procedures) are governed by DAFMAN 13-204V1.

A7.1.2. Program Objectives.

A7.1.3. Evaluate from an operational viewpoint, airfield operations for safety, compatibility, and adequacy.

A7.1.4. Evaluate functional areas within the air traffic system for compliance with USAF, FAA, MAJCOM, or applicable host nation (e.g., International Civil Aviation Organization and North Atlantic Treaty Organization) requirements, as applicable.

A7.1.5. Identify negative trends and oversee corrective actions.

A7.1.6. Identify positive trends and successful practices for benchmark and cross-utilization.

A7.1.7. Identify shortfalls in compliance of Air Force policies or previously implemented corrective actions.

A7.2. Scheduling Inspections.

A7.2.1. MAJCOMs will conduct AO-CV evaluations where they have functional responsibility (to include host nation locations) for AOM, ATC, AM or RAWS. **(T-2)**

MAJCOMs will ensure an upcoming (fiscal year) AO-CV schedule and augmentation requests to AFFSA and subordinate units is provided annually. **(T-1)** See DAFI 90-302 for additional scheduling guidance. AO-CV inspections for expeditionary units is at the discretion of the applicable MAJCOM and DAFI 90-302 guidance.

A7.2.2. MAJCOM AO-CV Team Chief will coordinate inspections with the MAJCOM IG Gatekeeper not later than 60 days prior to an event or as soon as possible when an AO-CV is required, based on negative safety trend requirements. **(T-2)** This coordination includes any visits to conduct a SAV, audit, certify, accredit, or evaluate a unit. Gatekeeper scheduling requirements can be found in DAFI 90-302.

A7.2.3. After coordinating with gatekeeper, the team chief may work with the AOF/CC to provide a list of AO-CV team requirements (e.g., office space, computer support, and phones), a request for any locally identified items requiring special attention and AO-CV questionnaires (as determined and created by the MAJCOMs) along with instructions for their distribution, completion, and collection. **Note:** MAJCOMs will make all efforts to not add additional workload on the units for items that are already available via other means (SharePoint®, MICT, etc.). **(T-2)**

A7.2.4. Evaluations will follow a 24-month cycle for Department of the Air Force locations and a 48-month cycle for each ANG wing. **(T-2)** **Note:** ANG will conduct their own AO-CV inspections. When able, MAJCOMs will minimize operational impact by conducting evaluations concurrently with other evaluations and inspections (e.g., IG or FAA inspections). Evaluation frequency may be adjusted plus or minus 6 months to support reducing the evaluation team footprint if the AO-CV is combined with other inspection/evaluation programs.

A7.2.5. MAJCOMs can conduct an AO-CV at any time based on negative safety trends or unsafe conditions identified through trend and analysis, such as mishap reports, near mid-air collision, HATRs, runway incursions/CMAV violations, loss of required ATC separation events, controller rating suspensions, and/or aircrew safety action program reports.

A7.3. Conducting the Evaluation. AO-CV evaluations consist of two distinct, but related, components that are normally conducted simultaneously: a system evaluation for safety of operations and a compliance evaluation for conformity to checklist criteria based on written instructions. Evaluators will observe airfield operations, review local airfield procedures, readiness of units (AFFORGEN) and evaluate safety compliance. **(T-2)** A system evaluation is appropriate to contracted locations or functions, whereas a compliance evaluation should only be applied in accordance with the performance work standard or statement of work. If MAJCOMs have direct functional (AOM, ATC, AM or RAWS) oversight of contracting officer's representative (COR) and those CORs periodically conduct on-site evaluations using MAJCOM-approved checklists, this meets the intent of the evaluation program, and a formal system evaluation is not required. Alternatively, MAJCOMs may seek cooperative agreements with the FAA Air Traffic Evaluations Division, AAT-100, to evaluate ATC service contracts. MAJCOMs will determine whether AO-CV or quality assurance visits by a subject matter expert (SME) quality assurance evaluator is appropriate at contracted locations. **(T-2)**

A7.3.1. Inspection Findings Management:

A7.3.1.1. Purpose. Evaluators will ensure inspection reports document primary and non-primary inspection activity findings, including safety, and surety. **(T-2)** These concerns may directly affect an overall inspection rating at the discretion of the inspection Team Chief. Recommended Improvement Areas are used to identify areas where a more efficient or effective course of action is available. Do not use Recommended Improvement Areas to document procedural deviations or non-compliance.

A7.3.1.2. Self-identified findings. Critical self-assessments foster a continuous improvement process and reduce reliance on external inspection teams. Holistically, self-assessments build cohesive bonds of trust between commanders, Airmen, and evaluators. This trust begins with the shared goal of improving the unit's effectiveness. A key component to building and sustaining trust in the Department of the Air Force Inspection System is creating an environment where Airmen feel they can safely report the ground truth with accuracy, underpinning a professional AO enterprise. Evaluators may duplicate deficiencies or observations in Inspector General Enterprise Management System (IGEMS), MICT, or other self-assessment documentation/tracking methods by the inspected organization if the inspected organization has not accurately identified the nature, validity, or severity of the deficiency; an acceptable corrective action plan with a practical suspense; or for the purpose of identifying a repeat deficiency.

A7.3.1.3. Validation. MAJCOM evaluators will establish and document a validation process providing the inspected unit or the organization with the deficiency an opportunity to clarify any findings identified during the inspection in a timely manner. **(T-2)** Prior to the inspection being finalized, inspectors will coordinate with the inspected unit on CRITICAL, SIGNIFICANT, MINOR, and off-checklist deficiencies identified during the inspection and document collaboration.

A7.3.1.4. Format will follow DAFI 90-302 specifications for write-ups and overall inspection ratings. Sample reports and template can be found at the AFFSA/XA SharePoint® (**https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/affsa/SitePages/Airfield-Operations.aspx**). AO-CV reports must be completed and distributed within 30 days of evaluation to wing and/or IGs (for IGEMS tracking), applicable operations group(s), operation support squadron(s), as well as uploaded to AFFSA/XA SharePoint®. **(T-1)**

A7.3.1.4.1. Evaluators will describe deficiencies in detailed, factual narrative to clearly report areas requiring resolution. **(T-2)** The written description alone should be adequate for the inspected organization to begin corrective action planning.

A7.3.1.4.2. Reference to the applicable instruction, technical order, or other source documentation from which the requirement is derived. **(T-2)**

A7.3.1.4.3. A severity (CRITICAL, SIGNIFICANT, or MINOR) based on impact to the organization's mission. **(T-2)**

A7.3.1.4.4. Overall assessment of the air traffic system. Make specific note of strengths and weaknesses. Final inspection ratings: HIGHLY EFFECTIVE, EFFECTIVE, MARGINALLY-EFFECTIVE AND INEFFECTIVE. An overall INEFFECTIVE rating will generate a Follow-up Inspection. **(T-2)** When an inspection results in an overall INEFFECTIVE rating, the MAJCOM will notify AFFSA/XA org box (**hqaffsa.xa@us.af.mil**) within 1 duty day. **(T-1)**

A7.3.1.4.4.1. INEFFECTIVE Rating and re-inspection will be accomplished within 12 months of initial inspection.

A7.3.1.4.5. Identify the office of primary responsibility charged with resolving the deficiency and any offices of coordinating responsibility charged with assisting in resolving the deficiency. **(T-2)**

A7.3.1.4.6. For deficiencies involving host/tenant organizations outside the inspected unit's chain of command or non-Air Force entities, categorize as higher headquarters/support agency deficiencies. **(T-2)**

A7.3.1.4.7. List the functional area (AOM, AM, ATC, or RAWS) for all findings to enable functional analysis and feedback. **(T-2)**

A7.4. Briefings.

A7.4.1. Team In-brief and daily briefings. It is recommended that the AOF/CC coordinate and schedule an AOB on the first day of the AO-CV as an In-Brief. The in-brief is still required if the AOB is not utilized for the WG/CD or designated representative; not to be delegated lower than the senior operations commander or equivalent. **(T-2)** The AOF/CC will coordinate any additional meetings as requested by MAJCOM/team chief. **(T-2)**

A7.4.2. Team out brief. The AOF/CC will coordinate and schedule the final out-brief with the WG/CD or designated representative; not to be delegated lower than the senior operations commander or equivalent. **(T-2)** The following information must be briefed by the MAJCOM AO team chief (at a minimum). **(T-2)**

A7.4.2.1. Overall assessment of the air traffic system. Make specific note of strengths and weaknesses. Final inspection ratings: HIGHLY EFFECTIVE, EFFECTIVE, MARGINALLY-EFFECTIVE AND INEFFECTIVE. **Note:** An overall ineffective rating will generate a follow-up inspection. **(T-2)**

A7.4.2.1.1. HIGHLY EFFECTIVE – The rating given to indicate performance or operations exceed mission requirements. Procedures and activities are carried out in a superior manner. Resources and programs are very efficiently managed and mostly deficiency-free. Risk-based criteria are often applied when allocating resources and making decisions. Root-Cause Analysis is often used to find and fix problems. Processes in place are mature and well established. Deficiencies are rare.

A7.4.2.1.2. EFFECTIVE – The rating given to indicate performance or operations meet expectations and mission requirements. Procedures and activities are carried out in an effective and efficient manner. Resources and programs are managed with few deficiencies. Risk-based criteria are usually applied when allocating resources and making decisions. Root-Cause Analysis is usually used to find and fix problems. Processes in place are sufficient to meet mission requirements. Deficiencies exist which do not impede or limit mission accomplishment.

A7.4.2.1.3. MARGINALLY-EFFECTIVE – The rating given to indicate performance or operations barely meeting expectations and mission requirements. Procedures and activities are carried out, but not in an effective or efficient manner. Resources and programs are insufficiently managed with some deficiencies. Risk and resource scarcity is sometimes considered in decision-making. Little effort is given to increasing

efficiency or reliability or use of root-cause analysis. Processes are not well-established causing inconsistent results. Deficiencies exist which may impede or limit mission accomplishment.

A7.4.2.1.4. INEFFECTIVE – The rating given to indicate performance or operation needs significant improvement. Procedures and activities are not carried out in a competent manner or produce unreliable results. Resources and programs are not well-managed. Risk and resource scarcity is rarely considered in decision-making processes. No effort at increasing efficiency or reliability is evident. Deficiencies exist which impede or limit mission accomplishment.

A7.4.2.2. Results of SIIs evaluated. **(T-2)**

A7.4.2.3. Findings/deficiencies. Identify all findings/deficiencies and indicate urgency of resolution. Indicate severity as (CRITICAL, SIGNIFICANT, or MINOR) based on impact to the organization's mission. **(T-2)**

A7.4.2.4. Off-Checklist Problems. Identify the number of problems found and define relative impact of noncompliance (e.g., aircraft separation errors vs. minor administrative oversight). **(T-2)**

A7.4.2.5. Required follow-up actions. Specify when the unit should expect the report, the contents of the report, reply instructions and the tracking and closing processes. **(T-2)**

A7.5. Checklists. Evaluators will use the downloadable SACs available on the AFFSA XA Airfield Operations Directorate SharePoint® (**https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/affsa/SitePages/Airfield-Operations.aspx**) to evaluate compliance with established guidance and standards. **(T-2)** MICT will be used to track checklists. **(T-2)**

A7.5.1. Off-Checklist Problems. MAJCOM supplemental requirements are deficiencies related to non-compliance with regulatory guidance not found in HAF/MAJCOM SACs. AFFSA/XA will analyze off-checklist problems for trends and may add related checklist items to SACs.

A7.6. Special Interest Items. SIIs focus management's attention on negative trends or emergent compliance updates that require particular attention to prevent significant AO safety challenges. MAJCOM staff identify annual AO-CV SIIs using trend data from the previous year's AO-CV reports and by anticipating emergent issues with potential mission impact within their command. Recognizing the subjectivity of SII checklists, one or more unsatisfactory item(s) does not automatically render the entire SII unsatisfactory. The SII would only be unsatisfactory if the extent and gravity of deficiencies have mission impact or safety of flight implications, (i.e., justify a CRITICAL write-up).

A7.7. Deficiency Resolution Instructions. The senior operations commander or equivalent will ensure AO-CV findings and actions taken to resolve deficiencies are addressed per this manual and MAJCOM supplemental guidance. **(T-2)**

A7.7.1. Findings Resolution. MAJCOM airfield operations branch is the closure authority for CRITICAL and SIGNIFICANT deficiencies. For all other deficiencies, commanders will determine the appropriate level of CAP approval and deficiency closure at the lowest appropriate command or IG-level. **(T-1)** The closure authority for deficiencies may be delegated to WG/CCs to expedite the closure process and will be delegated in the associated

AO-CV report, as applicable to each specific deficiency. The MAJCOM airfield operations staff will notify the wing in writing of CRITICAL and SIGNIFICANT findings for closure via IGEMS or email (if unable to use IGEMS) and wing's will notify MAJCOM airfield operations staff for MINOR findings via the same means. **(T-2)**

A7.7.2. MAJCOM evaluation teams will provide the inspected unit with closure instructions. **(T-2)** The inspected unit will provide associated corrective action plans to MAJCOM airfield operations branch, no later than 45 calendar days (90 calendar days for AFR units after being assigned in IGEMS or tracked through AOBs, if IGEMS is not available. **(T-2)** MAJCOM airfield operations evaluators will assign any deficiency cause codes required to describe the deficiency (use only one root cause per deficiency). **(T-2)**

A7.7.3. Additional guidance on closing deficiencies in IGEMS or MICT are listed in DAFI 90-302.

A7.7.4. Corrective action plans will include root-cause(s), deficiency cause codes. **(T-2)** Deficiency cause codes explanations can be found in DAFI 90-302, corrective action plan, offices of primary responsibility, and estimated closure dates. Corrective action plans are required for CRITICAL and SIGNIFICANT deficiencies; MAJCOM Airfield Operations staff will work with IGs to ensure this data is documented in IGEMS. **(T-1)** If not tracked through IGEMS, AOF/CC will ensure this data is tracked through AOBs. **(T-1)** The corrective action plan approval authority (owning MAJCOM) must approve, modify, or reject (with associated constructive comments) within 15 calendar days of receipt (30 calendar days for ARC units). **(T-2)**

A7.7.5. Squadron commanders and AOF/CCs, or civilian equivalent, will ensure root-cause analysis is completed for CRITICAL and SIGNIFICANT deficiencies using the problem-solving approach/tool and level of effort best suited to the situation. **(T-2)** **Note:** This does not include off-checklist problems.

A7.7.6. MAJCOM airfield operations branch will quarterly track status of open deficiencies tracked in IGEMS or AOB (if unable to use IGEMS). **(T-2)**

A7.7.7. MAJCOM airfield operations branch may close the deficiency (CRITICAL and SIGNIFICANT) when the corrective action plan is entered in IGEMS, is fully implemented, and the results of the plan have been validated by the MAJCOM evaluation team.

A7.7.8. Deficiencies should be closed within 12 months (18 months for ANG) from the date of the write-up listed in the AO-CV report, if all applicable corrective actions are completed.

A7.8. Follow-up Evaluations. A follow-up evaluation may be conducted as deemed necessary by MAJCOM AO staff. Normally, this determination will be based on the number and potential/actual impact of system deficiencies identified during the AO-CV. An overall ineffective rating will generate a follow-up inspection.

A7.8.1. Team members will assess wing/unit progress in correcting deficiencies and offer further recommendations, as applicable, to assist with the finding's resolutions process. **(T-2)** Evaluators will review documented action taken to correct previously identified deficiencies and confirm closure for those deficiencies that have been resolved. **(T-2)** **Note:** Should a functional area follow-up evaluation be required, only the specific functional area will be re-evaluated. **(T-2)**

A7.8.2. Follow-up evaluations, if necessary, will be completed within 12 months of the AO-CV and will be accomplished by an on-site visit or virtual inspection. **(T-2)**

A7.8.3. Completion of a follow-up evaluation does not reset the AO-CV cycle; next AO-CV will be conducted IAW timelines outlined in **paragraph A7.2.4**. **(T-2)**

A7.8.4. MAJCOMs should advise the wing and/or MAJCOM gatekeeper at least 30 days prior to conducting an on-site follow-up evaluation. See MAJCOM-specific guidance for inspection scheduling additional details for follow-up evaluations.

A7.9. Benchmarks. A benchmark is a process, procedure, or activity which clearly establishes a superior standard of service or performance. Benchmarks have a high potential to apply to a broader organizational spectrum than where the process, program, or technique was originally employed. Inspection teams process benchmarks as follows:

A7.9.1. Any inspector may identify potential benchmarks during the normal course of conducting inspections. The author of a benchmark will include the name and contact information of the individual at the applicable pertinent oversight authority for the submission, a description of whether the benchmark was accepted, and any concerns will be listed in the narrative portion of the IGEMS report. After the MAJCOM team chief approves a benchmark, it becomes part of the final inspection report.

A7.9.2. Units or individuals who developed benchmarks identified by inspectors may further submit them for formal approval through the Airmen Powered by Innovation process outlined in DAFI 38-402, *Airmen Powered by Innovation and Suggestion Program*.

A7.10. Superior Performers. MAJCOM airfield operations finspection team should highlight superior performers during the AO-CV. Members of the airfield operations flight that demonstrate superior performance in (e.g., carrying out their duty, professionalism, created innovative programs or processes etc.) should be highlighted by the MAJCOM airfield operations inspection team. There is no limit to the number of Superior Performers; it will be at the discretion of the airfield operations inspection team to select.